

Efn 402

COMPARATIVE AND INTERNATIONAL EDUCATION

### FOUNDATIONS OF COMPARATIVE EDUCATION: GENERAL THEORY

#### **Introduction**

An overview of the course unit: definition, scope, aims/purpose and rationale of Comparative Education

#### 1.1 DEFINATION

##### **Berredy G. Z. F**

Looks at theories and practices and defines it as an academic discipline which looks at educational systems across national borders. The main aim is to compare structure, administration, financing, curriculum, goals of education etc.

##### **Isaac Kandel**

He looks at national systems and how they compare and contrast.

##### **Harold Noah and Max Eckstein**

Comparative education is at the intersection of social sciences, education and cross-national study. You cannot study comparative education in isolation. An education system is a social science.

##### **Peter Raggatt**

Comparative education is the cross-national study of general propositions about relationships between education and society and between educational relationships

##### **Working definition**

Comparative education is an academic discipline that analyses in details the education systems across national boundaries with the aim of identifying similarities and differences in order to institute educational reforms. Emphasis is on goals of education, structure, administration, financing, curriculum etc.

#### 1.2 OBJECTIVES

1. Provide a picture or profile of the education system in various countries or regions
2. Come up with a descriptive classification of education in various parts of the world.
3. Determine relations and aspects in the education and society e.g. how does family size affect education? How does social status affect education? What are the motivations of different social classes to participate in education?
4. Determine the fundamental elements of education persistence and change and relate them with philosophical laws.

##### **Forms of comparative education**

1. Comparative pedagogy
2. Intra cultural analysis
3. International education
4. Development education

##### **1. Comparative pedagogy.**

This entails the study of classroom dynamics in different education systems and looks at issues such as:

- What goes on inside the classroom?
- How is learning? Is it teacher or student centered?

- How do teachers relate to their students?
- What are the common teaching methods?

### 2. Intra cultural analysis.

An examination of various factors that impact on education such as:

Cultural, Social, Economic, Religious, Political, Historical, Philosophical

### 3. International education.

Includes the study of multinational institutions as well as international efforts in order to harmonize curriculum, textbooks with the aim of developing objectives for purposes of creating international norms or standards

It also includes the study of international institutions such as UNESCO with regard to policy matters intended to harmonize education standards of qualifications, promotions of education exchanges and initiations of cultural agreements.

There is also a lot of work in the area of equivalences in education e.g. How does a Kenyan degree compare to an Indian degree or how does a British diploma compare to Kenyan diploma?

### 4. Development education.

This is an effort especially by the developed world to produce information and plans which assist policy makers in developing countries. It also involves the development of appropriate education methods and techniques for training of human resources in various programs.

### Scope of Comparative Education

Compare single unit e.g. PISA (Programme for International Student Assessment) 65 member countries coordinated by OECD (Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development)

1. Subject matter/content perspective- Covers aims, curriculum, administration, financing, teacher education and structure.
2. Geographical unit/area perspective- Covers intra- national, international, continental and global
3. Thematic scope- Focuses on themes, topical issues or problems
4. Special historical scope- *Historical development of education*

### 1.3. PURPOSE OF STUDYING COMPARATIVE EDUCATION

#### 1. To know other people.

Through comparative education, one develops a reservoir of knowledge which tends to satisfy ones intellectual curiosity besides enhancing ones intellectual enlightenment.

Vernon Mallinson- argued that “*familiarity with what is being done in countries other than one’s own and why it’s done is a necessary part of training of all serious students of educational issues of the day*”

#### 2. To improve education at home.

By studying other people's education system, we get to develop a better perspective of our own education system.

Michael Saddler argues that *"the study of education elsewhere enhances understanding of education at home"*

Isaac Kandel- argued that *"the study of foreign systems of education means a critical approach and a challenge to one's own philosophy and therefore a clearer analysis of the background and bases underlying the education system of one's own country"*

### **3. Planning.**

Planning requires careful selection of objectives. It's often a delicate process which requires scientific and rational decisions to be made. Consequently it entails the development of human resources. Comparative Education therefore provides data upon which policy decisions key to planning are made.

### **4. To make people practical.**

Education is a consumer good. It therefore must have practical utility e.g. utility to read and write. There is a general belief that an educated person works better. This explains why most countries spend a lot on education. Hence the task of making education practical is the duty of the government and educationalists. Comparative Education therefore is considered to be very suitable for studying these aspects. How education system is practical hence need for reform. How practical is it elsewhere i.e. Global North, Global South, BRICS

### **5. Humanitarian reasons.**

The contemporary world is characterized by a big quest for knowledge, peace, equality and better life. The concern therefore is how education can provide these qualities. In many countries today, the question of peace and equality are key issues in education. Look at human rights violation all over the world- Syria, Iraq, Yemen, Ukraine Afghanistan, south Sudan, Russia, Israel, Palestine, Libya, Sudan, Rwanda Eritrea, Mexico, Somalia, DRC, Liberia etc.

### **6. Problem solving.**

Since each country is often faced by various problems, it becomes necessary to study how other countries may solve similar problems e.g. the problem of school dropout, drug and substance abuse, student's strikes, teenage pregnancy, HIV/AIDS. Implementation of FPE, CBC curriculum, Learn how to attain total literacy like Cuba, centralized and decentralized education in France and USA.

### **7. Expose people to innovations.**

Today, people use various media to conduct education activities i.e. the internet, Television, radio, Open University, AVU, distance learning. By studying other education systems, one learns how to use such media and the benefits of the same and this brings about educational reform.

### **8. Understand economic implication of education.**

There is an argument that there is a correlation between education and economic theory improvement. The wealth of the nation by Adams Smith: Look at developed world and their economies Comparative education therefore examines whether and where this is true. Improving education without economic perspective leads to unemployment and brain drain- Zimbabwe, Kenya

### **9. Contribution to international understanding and goodwill.**

After the Second World War, there emerged a consensus that there is need for people to come together to seek solutions towards international understanding (UNESCO), International Bureau of Education (IBE), ILO

Today, the world faces problems that can be best solved through cooperation. Comparative education has played and continues to play a very important role in promoting this international understanding.

### **10. Relaxing national pride**

It's necessary to combat feelings of superiority, especially among the populations of countries technologically and economically developed and with military prowess. They need to understand that other countries are essential for sustenance and therefore have to work for mutual benefit of each other. South Africa and xenophobia

## **2. HISTORICAL DEVELOPMENT OF COMPARATIVE EDUCATION**

The development of comparative education has been divided into several phases. They include,

- Pre-history or period travelers
- Period of pioneers 1817-1900
- Period of philosophers 1900-1945
- Period of social science perspective 1945-todate

### **2.1. Phase I: Pre-history or period of travelers.**

This was before 1817 and is called pre- history because comparative education had not gotten a methodology. It was marked by descriptive reports by various travelers including military conquerors, business men and explorers.

Scholars include;

#### **(i) Xenophile**

An Athenian scholar who gave a description of education that was given to citizens in Persia. He compared the aims and structure of the Persian education system with that of Sparta. He admired the Spartan education and wished that the Athenians would copy it.

#### **(ii) Plato.**

He wrote two books - *The law* and *The Republican* where he described the Spartan education system. He admired the Spartan education system because it was state controlled and emphasized discipline that was military type. He argued that the Athenian education was likely to bring about permissiveness and lack of social order because it did not emphasize discipline. He therefore recommended the Athenians to copy Sparta

#### **(iii)Julius Caesar.**

Julius Caesar was a Roman emperor who described how children were educated in countries beyond Rome. He also admired the Spartan education system that was state controlled.

### **(iv) Marco Polo.**

He described the Chinese education system. He observed that there were no quarrels in schools in China. He also noted that honesty and truthfulness were emphasized. He further observed that men and women lived together peacefully in China a fact he attributed to education system. However in 19<sup>th</sup> century, scholars observed that the Chinese education system contributed greatly to the corrupt government system, breaking of laws and cruelty of prisoners.

### **(v) Cicero.**

He studied in Greece and wrote *DE REPUBLICA* where he admired the training in oratory of Greeks and suggested a state controlled education system by Romans like that of Sparta.

### **Conclusion**

The above accounts and others which are travelers tell were mainly motivated by curiosity. Most of the travelers were looking for lessons from others. Generally, all these reports were descriptive and unsystematic, exaggerated at times and understatement at other times hence they were of little comparative value. But they still formed the basis of comparison.

## **2.2. Phase II: Period of Pioneers (1817-1900)**

### **Marc Antoine Jullien de Paris**

Was born in 1775 in Paris and as he grew up, he distinguished himself as a scholar. He became a diplomat in Napoleons government. His job gave him an opportunity to travel widely. As he travelled, he noticed the crisis created by Napoleonic wars. He was more concerned about deterioration of society after these wars. In 1817, he published 2 books

- Comparative education plans
- Preliminary views on comparative education

In the books, he noted that nationalism had brought war and differences in Europe. For France, he believed that the political and business life was based on self-interest. There were numerous education challenges in European society. According to Marc, he believed that the solutions to these problems lay in education.

However, he was concerned that the ability of individual school systems to improve themselves was limited. He therefore proposed the following;

- ✓ Establishment of education commission to collect and distribute information among member countries.
- ✓ Collection of facts and observations arranged in analytical charts which permit both to be related and compared.
- ✓ Establishment of a normal institute of education as a demonstration Centre for the best teaching methods in Europe.

### **Impact of major contribution of de Paris on education**

He recommended the following in education

- ❖ Comparative education methodologies and analytical methods emerged after his contributions.
- ❖ The bureau of education was started in Europe which later become part of United Nations and eventually gave rise to the establishment of UNESCO.
- ❖ Borrowings become a method in comparative education with aim of transplanting. This borrowing involved cataloguing of data and lessons on borrowing.
- ❖ Scholars after him such as Victor Cousin studied foreign education systems with an intention to transplant. These studies however were descriptive rather than analytical.

- ❖ Following the industrial revolution, came imperialism and missionary movements. The imperialists and missionaries took their education systems and planted them in the new lands.
- ❖ Education administrators, reformers, politicians and experts in various fields no longer travelled for general curiosity but to specifically discover what was happening in education overseas in order to improve their own education systems.
- ❖ Various national agencies were established for collection, and distribution of information about education i.e. United States Office on education.
- ❖ By the end of the century, most government were increasingly funding and encouraging studies on foreign education system and this promoted comparative education.

### **2.3. Phase III: The period of philosophers (1900-1945)**

This period is also called period of cultural analysis. There was a general uneasiness by many scholars about restrictive studies. Emphasis in comparative education shifted to analysis. This meant that scholars at this time were increasingly getting interested in the relations between education and society.

Scholars include:

1. **William Diltthey**

He argued that comparative studies could bring countries together.

2. **William Harris**

Comparative education studies could reveal universal relations between education and society. Education breaks down the caste system and brings democracy in society.

3. **Lavassaur**

Studies based on cultural forces or factors beyond national boundaries would explain variations in education studies.

4. **Michael Saddler**

Education and society are closely related and that scholars must be studied in the context of the society. He said comparisons cannot be made on statistics only but that the social, political, economic and other related factors should be looked into. *“The things outside school often influence the things inside the school and matter even more”*

5. **Isaac Kandel**

Every nation has a character which is often as a result of its history and philosophy. According to him, broad social movements and political waves across national boundaries do affect national systems of education differently, hence he did not believe in borrowing.

Studies in this period were mainly motivated by the following

- ✓ Studying problems of international concern.
- ✓ Promoting humanitarian sentiments e.g. human rights, equality etc.
- ✓ Contributing to solutions of world problems.
- ✓ Fostering international cooperation and understanding.
- ✓ Identifying worldwide movements in education.

During this period, there was great caution on borrowing. Many scholars emphasized that any borrowed idea should be analyzed thoroughly hence there was a great emphasis on selective cultural borrowing.

### 2.4. Phase IV: Period of Social Science Perspective (1945-to date)

This is the period of 2<sup>nd</sup> world war and it brought a completely new scenario in world order. The distinct features include;

- (i) **An explosion of knowledge**  
The challenge is how this knowledge ought to be disseminated. It has also brought new roles for teachers.
- (ii) **Technical development devoted to destruction** i.e. nuclear weapons, chemical weapons.
- (iii) **Drive for knowledge worldwide**  
Since then, and up to date, everybody wants education both in developing and developed countries.
- (iv) **Drive for liberty**  
This has brought about liberation struggles (democratic institutions). Education has been at the Centre of this struggle hence liberation movements have always offered education for the masses for either political or economic gains. There has also emerged cultural and intellectual liberalism.
- (v) **Rapid urbanization and industrialization**
- (vi) **Population explosion**  
This has led to population related problems e.g. in Kenya, over 50% of population is of school going age. This means that their education and upkeep has to be catered for by a very small working population.
- (vii) **Concerned for quality education**  
There has been a lot of emphasis on education that is relevant to the life needs of the learners/students. This has created a lot of interest in education worldwide. Comparative educationists have been called upon by international agencies to help solve the myriad educational problems.
- (viii) Comparative education has become part of the development of specialized interdisciplinary fields and this emerged with expansion of graduate education in North America.
- (ix) **World power shift**  
After the 2<sup>nd</sup> world war, there was an accelerated shift of world power from the Great Britain to USA and former USSR. Communism and capitalism took Centre stage and the world was divided accordingly. Consequently, this had a big effect on national systems of education.
- (x) With the USA assuming Centre place in world politics, there was a great need for American presence in an understanding of the culture and education of other countries.
- (xi) Many agencies such as ford foundation started to fund and continue to fund research and development of comparative education as part of the wider USA foreign policy.
- (xii) A major issue on methodology in comparative education and research was actively debated by comparative educationists including Berredy, Brian Holmes, and Arnold Noah among others.

- (xiii) Today, comparative education is taught in many universities both at undergraduate and post-graduate levels.
- (xiv) There are numerous publications in comparative education including magazines, journals, books and internet.
- (xv) There are numerous national, regional and international comparative education associations which bring together scholars in comparative education e.g. World Council of Comparative Education Societies (WCCES), Comparative and International Education Society (CIES), South African Comparative and History Education Society (SACHES), Africa for Research in Comparative Education (AFRICE)

### 3. DEVELOPMENT OF COMPARATIVE EDUCATION AS AN INDEPENDENT ACADEMIC DISCIPLINE

Comparative education has developed as a field devoted to the study of **education systems in other countries**. Over the last three decades, there has been an intense debate over its **methodology and content** and schools of thought guiding each research and types of knowledge that have been generated.

Even though comparative education has **its roots in 19<sup>th</sup> century, it's new in the main stream academic world. Within Universities, comparative education was established as a distinct area of study after the Second World War**. Since that time, it has sort to delineate itself as a distinct area of inquiry in educational studies.

Unlike other fields such as psychology, sociology, philosophy and history whose subject matter and methodology are well defined, comparative education has in the last 30 years had to develop as a distinct scholarly discipline. Due to its **very wide and varied clientele**, comparative education has seen very **eclectic** (not restricted to one source of knowledge) and has failed to develop one simple widely **acceptable method of inquiry**. Moreover, it has not established a unitary body of knowledge and rather comparative education remains a field characterized by **methodological debates** and diversity of opinions as to what constitutes its subject matter and orientation.

Before the 1950s, comparative education had a long tradition as an outlined field of study that assisted in education reform locally and internationally. The demands of **internal reform** and **foreign policy** and patterns of research findings **shaped the field of comparative education**.

In USA, patterns of funding as well as dominant research orientation in the social sciences and particularly in post second world war period have shaped and continued to shape the field of comparative.

**Modernization theory** has until very recently guided much of the research and comparative education has often been a field to foreign assistance programs and the intellectual and ideological orientations of the aid giving agencies. However, the fact that a consensus over the methods, content and parameters of comparative education has not yet emerged, it should not be taken to mean that comparative education has no legitimacy within the intellectual world, rather the continuity debate and fluidity of the field and its wide diversity may be taken to indicate a basic vitality and dynamism of the study of comparative education.

### 3.1. CLIENTELE OF COMPARATIVE EDUCATION

Comparative education has a broad based clientele including;

- Policy makers
- Administrators
- Students
- International agencies
- Other academicians both in education and other social sciences.

One of the most significant accomplishments in the field of comparative education in the last 30 years has been the development of an institutional and intellectual community. Comparative education has developed in a way similar to the establishment of social sciences beginning with small scale scholars in a few countries working largely on national basis, the field has **entranced itself in international agencies such as UNESCO and other developed national and regional societies in various countries and this has resulted in publications of various journals regularly.**

**Also in universities, academic departments and programs** have established themselves in the field and hence attracting a significant number especially at the graduate level. In the area of professional training, America and British universities have traditionally dominated the field. Recently however, numerous universities in other countries such as Germany, South Africa, Botswana and East African countries have established comparative education as an academic discipline for both **undergraduate and postgraduate level.**

**In addition to those academic Centre, a number of non-university institutions** have shown major interest in comparative education where they provide training and generate considerable research and data.

Examples of non-university include;

- International Institute for Education Planning (IIEP).
- International Bureau of Education(IBE)
- Max Planck institutes in Germany
- Institute for education and research - Herzberg
- World Bank WB)
- Ford foundation
- Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD)

#### *British Council (BC)*

Also, there are numerous other private agencies which engage in training research and publishing activities involving comparative education studies. This shows that there are various groups that are interested in field of comparative education as a field of inquiry and research.

### 3.2 SOCIETIES

There are numerous national, regional and international comparative education associations which bring together **scholars** in comparative education. The umbrella society is World Council of Comparative Education Societies (WCCES), created in 1970 as an NGO through UNESCO. The objectives of the society are: promote international understanding, peace, intercultural

cooperation, mutual respect among all people and observation of human rights, improve education systems so as to achieve more effective implementation of the right to education for all and promote the contribution of comparative education to the study of major world problems by encouraging cooperation by specialists from all over the world. Regional societies include Comparative and International Education Society (CIES), Comparative Education Society in Europe

(CESE), Japan Comparative Education Society (JCES), Korean Comparative Education Society (KCES), Comparative Education Society of Hong Kong (CESHK), South African Comparative and History Education Society (SACHES), Africa for Research in Comparative Education (AFRICE)

Comparative education is a discipline in the field of education that studies /examines education in one country/countries by using data and insights drawn from the practices and situation in other country/countries with a view of borrowing the best and finding the challenges and attempted solutions to the challenges.

The education societies and other organizations like UNICEF, USAID, and UNESCO play a greater role in the development of comparative education as an academic field in a number of ways.

Financial aid to nations that are members of those organizations such as USAID and World Bank offer financial assistance to fund educational programmes in different states this is in line with the field of comparative education which is basically concerned with the field of education. With the financial aid to education the study of education and to extension comparative education is enhanced as funds are central to research and implementation of various projects.

Being a field of education, comparative education has broad areas of learning ranging from basic education: pre-primary and primary. Tertiary education and adult education. Organizations such as UNICEF complements this area of comparative education as its core aim is to fund children's education and more so in disaster prone areas and conflict regions with specific interests to children education. Such support contributes to the sustainability of education to the intended population (children) with that population kept in schools then comparative education is sustained and best practices are applied/shared in different parts of the world for children.

Organizations such as UNESCO do publishing in various fields and topics on education matters which serve as a powerful basis for evaluation and decision making. This paves the way for comparative educationist to have support materials that are relevant for the study of comparative education.

Other agencies such as USAID has leading role in leverage of additional resources to partners in the field of education. They also have an active role in the advocacy for inclusive education policies and sharing of best practices which help to promote the growth of comparative education as member states get to share information from each other which is the role comparative education.

Education societies such as UNICEF set up commissions that study and reflect on the challenges facing education and makes recommendations for the best practices towards the solution of the challenges. This is in line with comparative education field which seeks to find the challenges bedeviling education in various areas and places hence it is a support towards the field of the comparative education when such organizations also delve in similar areas.

Comparative education as a field of study seeks to look at education from all human aspects that is child education, adult education, disabled/less privileged, girl child education among others. This is also an interest area of the UNICEF which advocates for access to primary education by all children. This gives a tremendous contribution towards the field of comparative education as application of best practices can be applied from the UN agency in the field of comparative education in support of education to all.

#### 4. METHODOLOGY IN COMPARATIVE EDUCATION

There are several methods used by scholars in their attempt to study comparative education. Methodology in comparative education as in any other education discipline is determined by the purpose of the study. Comparative education has been studied at different times of its development with different methodological approaches.

A close look at developmental phases reveal that **each phase produced a different type of work and this mainly depended on the dominant views and motives of the scholars at that time**. Starting with simple narrative abroad during the phase of travelers tells, methodology in comparative education has progressively evolved into the current application of the sophisticated and complex methods of social sciences which in most cases are empirically based.

#### Approaches

- I. Traditional methods**
  - Descriptive method.
  - Selective education borrowing
- II. Social Science Methodology**
  - Historical approach
  - Sociological approach
  - Philosophical approach
- III. Conventional methods**
  - Systematic study area
  - Problem solving approach
  - Scientific method approach.

##### 4.1 Traditional methods

###### (i) Descriptive method

Approach call for detailed description of education affairs of another country. Hence several comparative educationists presented detailed description accounts of the education systems of the countries they visited. Some of the scholars include: Marco polo, Herodotus, Xenophon, Cicero, and Julius Caesar.

### (ii) Selective Education Borrowing

This was mainly used pioneer stage and the main purpose then in comparative education was to in co-operate the good points of another country (Selective Education Borrowing). Statistics and descriptions formed the basis of comparison in order to facilitate transplantation of education system and promote understanding among nations. Materials to be collected may be historical and descriptive.

#### Application

- Invitation of foreign experts to advice on reform of institution/ education system e.g. Mackey report 1981
- Individual in a country appointed to lead a commission i.e. Ominde, Gachathi, Koech Commissions
- Government send officials to other countries to study a particular system i.e. village polytechnics from Russia, China, Japan.

#### Problems of the approach

- The problem of the reliability of data especially, inaccuracy of local records/technical terms
- Other factors to be compared especially on budgeting are determined by population considerations, social influences, political etc.
- Political rivalry and economic competition.

### 4.2 Social Science Method Approach

Several methods linked to other social science disciplines are considered

#### (i) Historical method

This method makes effort to study modern educational problems by looking at **causes and effects**. This method is important because we employ historical method not only to know the past, but in order to understand the present better so that we may improve the future by hinting at those factors which may be more useful.

Historical method helps us to understand all the geographical, social, racial, political, religious and linguistic factors which influence the education system of a country. In order to make proper use of this method, one should observe the following:

- i. Study each national educational system separately in its historical context taking into account differences in terminologies and methods of collecting and classifying data.
- ii. Analyze the factors/forces responsible for the noted differences that are often grouped into four categories i.e.
  - Natural factor like Race, Language, Environment.
  - Religious factors like Catholicism, Anglicanism, Islam
  - Social-economic factors like humanism, nationalism, socialism
  - Political factors.

Adopt only those ideas and practices that best approximate and can be adapted to the recipient countries historical context.

### Limitations

- (i) The data on which historical studies are based may not be often reliable because in the collection of data, due care is not often observed.
- (ii) Historians generally are not impartial in their accounts. In most cases, they are known to conceal undesirable elements about the history of their own countries with some perceived prejudice.
- (iii) This approach of using the past is often and unduly emphasized. Consequently, the comparative study in this context can be said to be unbalanced.

### (ii) Sociological/Analytical Method

It brings together relationship that exists between educational system of a country and its social, cultural, economic, religious and political situations. Most people doing comparative education advocate for analysis in comparative studies. The main argument is; through analysis, one can separate the various elements and understand the importance of each independently. The analytical method is considered useful since there is a close relationship between education and society.

It follows the following steps:

- (i) **Identification and collecting educational data.**  
All educational information is gathered through descriptive and statistical methods which often form the basis of analysis.
- (ii) **Analysis of related data**  
It involves analysis of social, political, economic and historical data which is necessary in order to understand similarities and differences found in education systems of various countries.
- (iii) **Determine standards for comparison.**  
In order to compare educational systems fairly, we need to have certain standards e.g. political philosophy, aims of education, structure of education, administration of education etc. Hence the analytical method formulates the standards to use.
- (iv) **Interpretation/ prediction and conclusion.**  
From the above three aspects of analysis, one is able to interpret collected data and make conclusions on basis of comparisons of various education systems of different countries and predict.

### Limitations

- a) Because of its nature, analytical method does not pay adequate attention to the totality of education system. Ignores some contributors to education.
- b) This method is often prone to ignoring the inherent similarities which exists in educational systems in spite of the differences in educational systems of various countries.

### (iii) Philosophical Analysis/ Synthesis Method

In this approach, the study of comparative education from an international point of view is considered to be of great significance because problems of education are considered and studied

on international framework. Education system is connected with the philosophy or different styles of arguing e.g. American Pragmatism; French Nationalism etc. Establishing the predominant mode of thought can be linked to every aspect of an educational organization.

### 4.3 Conventional methods

They are contemporary attempts to systematize methodology in comparative education research. They date back in 1960s during which intense methodological debate centered on the following four aspects

- (i) The feasibility of relying on a particular method as opposed to multidimensional approach.
- (ii) The feasibility of the nation-state as the dominant research framework as opposed to intra-national, regional and continental would system analyses.
- (iii) The over reliance on quantitative (statistical) approach as opposed to qualitative and descriptive research.
- (iv) The range of research concerns that have traditionally dominated studies in comparative education.

The result of this methodological debate culminated in new approaches to study comparative education. This are;

- a) Systematic Area studies Approach
- b) The problem solving Approach
- c) The scientific method Approach

#### **(a) Systematic Area Studies Approach (George E. Bereday 1964)**

This method was developed by George E. Bereday in his book Comparative methods in education (1964). He used the **interdisciplinary approach** to systematically survey, analyze education in different countries. In this method, the main aim is to understand **differences and similarities before borrowing and making any predictions**. He argues that since the study has to make sense out of similarities and differences in education system, then it's possible to seek assistance from other fields of study such as history, sociology and philosophy. This is because educational facts are enmeshed in a matrix of sciences that comparative education cannot be studied in isolation.

He proposed the following steps;

- (i) **Description**- this involves identification of the problem by clearly describing the problem from the eye witnesses' account or observations or reading available literature.
- (ii) **Interpretation** - this step, involves giving explanations/justification of information collected in each country. The reasons may be historical, geographical social-cultural, economic, political or religious.
- (iii) **Juxtaposition/ classification of data**- this involves putting information into groups or categories of contrasting and comparable features. In this way, similarities and differences can be easily and clearly be seen.
- (iv) **Comparison**- involves comparing features in one system with those of another system. At this stage, we give reasons why these are as they are.

- (v) **Suggestions, conclusion and generalizations**- we draw valid conclusions and making recommendations for new lines of action while focusing on the causes of similarities and differences.

In 1968, Edmund King proposed another method where he sees the role of comparative education is to assist in educational policy decision.

Steps:

- (i) Problem: an educational problem is identified
- (ii) Acquisition of data (Review of literature)
- (iii) A comparative analysis is done
- (iv) Policy making suggestion
- (v) Policy makers take a policy decision
- (vi) Policy implementation

(b) **Problem solving approach**

Was developed by Brian Holmes (1964) when he wrote a textbook “*Problem in education: A comparative approach*”. In this book, he borrowed heavily from the ideas of John Dewey the famous American educator/scholar. Brian based this approach on the five stages of reflective thinking/critical thinking to the study of comparative education issues. The stages are:

- (i) Problem identification. (General dissatisfaction)
- (ii) Problem analysis. (Describe the trends that are related to the problem)
- (iii) Proposed problem solutions.
- (iv) Specification of the context. (Factors, conditions, determinants which may have been over-looked by those who proposed the solutions)
- (v) Comparison ( verification stage, have things worked out as anticipated by those who proposed the solutions) stage 3/4
- (vi) Conclusion suggestion for the new line of action.

According to Brian Holmes, in the face of a problematic situation, possible solutions often spring to mind. On further reflection, the problem is further formulated. This further directs the solution to a certain kind of data out of which emerge refined possible solutions. These refined possible solutions are then put forward as hypothesis and then tested one after the other until the best solution is arrived at.

(c) **Scientific method approach**

This method was developed by Harold Noah and Max Eckstein (1969) when they wrote a book “*Towards a science of comparative education*”

They recommended the following steps:

- (i) Problem identification, determination of central concepts, terms and indicators.
- (ii) Review of related literature
- (iii) Selection/ sampling of units of study/ cases to be studied. (methodology)
- (iv) Data collection.

- (v) Data analysis and manipulation.
- (vi) Interpretation of data- findings and results.
- (vii) Valid conclusions and recommendations.

### SUBJECTS OF COMPARISON

The units of analysis that are commonly used as areas of comparison include: Comparing Areas, Comparing Times, Comparing Systems, Comparing Cultures, Comparing Policies, Comparing Themes, Comparing Values, Comparing of educational achievements, Comparing pedagogical innovations and comparing ways of learning.

#### A. Comparing areas

Comparing areas may include:

##### i. World regions/ continents:

It explains the nature of comparison at the level of world regions and continents, the assumptions that underlie them. In this case there are typical terms that are used such as Balkan States, European Community, the Caribbean and the South Pacific. Allied Macro-level work takes the continents as the unit of analysis, and focuses on such locations as Africa, South America or Asia. The main assumption is that regional comparisons are made possible by the shared characteristics that differentiate one region from another in educationally important ways. The unifying characteristics of any particular region may include language, political organization, colonial history, economic systems, national ambitions or cultural origins. Other examples include the establishment of regional bodies such as European Union (EU), North American Free Trade Agreement as other constructed entities that can be used for comparison. It should be noted that regional organizations are nested in a complex web of institutional relations, cultural and political practices and global developments.

##### ii. Countries:

Countries have been the dominant units of analysis in the field of comparative education. Various studies have been done involving cross national comparisons. In this case various constructs are used to discuss the education differences and similarities prevalent in the countries being discussed. In the process elements of differences such as political ideology, economic differences and educational provision can be discussed.

##### iii. States/ provinces:

This is intra-national comparison that involves the state or provinces. Among the factors that make the state/ provinces an appropriate unit of analysis is the high level of degree of decentralization in many countries. This unit of analysis is further important when there are significant levels of disparities existing within a country.

##### iv. Districts:

These comprises of areas that are below the provinces. These are important when there are significant intra-provincial variations or when the aggregate national and/ or provincial statistics are not reliable or are misleading due to significant variations across districts or technical difficulties in collecting data at higher levels. Issue of special administrative functions of the district will come on board.

##### v. Schools:

The school is a critical unit of analysis that comprises of the population that is enrolled and working in a particular school. The use of schools as units of comparison will include studying of the school cultures which is different from the rest of the larger units. The differences that arise from schools need to be highlighted even in a particular districts or provinces

##### vi. Classrooms:

The classroom has not been prominent as a traditional comparative education method in literature. However, classrooms offer an interesting space for comparative analyses such as the virtual space. Various studies that include the grades have been conducted such as the ones that deal with reading.

### **vii. Individuals:**

This is the lowest level of comparison according to Bray and Thomas Cube. This is where the study may focus on individuals such as principals, teachers, parents and pupils. Such studies may have many disciplinary orientations.

#### **B. Comparing times**

This approach uses a historical and comparative structure where time is discussed. The events are organized according to time. The second level includes the synchronic which presented static snapshots of various events. The third level is quasi-synchronic which encompasses a whole range of hybrids of the first two types.

#### **C. Comparing cultures**

Here, we consider different cultures of people who live in close proximity to each other, rise of the creed of multiculturalism and the philosophy of postmodernism with its rejection of metanarratives and its belief in multiple truths. The main role articulated is that of the individual sharing meanings and ways of life. There is a new focus on educational debates shifting increasingly towards how learning can be facilitated as opposed to teaching and on learning outcomes rather than on inputs.

#### **D. Comparing systems**

This has been involving the comparison of different education systems with a view of understanding how each is in relation to the nation state. In this case the intra-national studies fall on comparing of systems as the need to understand the political, economic, social cultural, historical and geographical characteristics that affect any education system.

#### **E. Comparing values**

The use of values has been highlighted by several authors among them Cumming et.al (1988), Heffron (1999). The values can be discussed from the personal perspectives and others can be collective perspective that focuses on social values, cultural values, political values, citizenship and belief systems such as religions and ideologies. More over others look at values from the perspectives of forms of knowledge. The concept of values is quite broad. They have to be discussed from collectively in the context of individual choices of values. Whenever values are focused on the individuals they are never separated from society at large.

#### **F. Comparing educational achievement.**

This is another area that comparative education has been involved in in understanding of educational achievement of various subjects. This has been done through agreement of procedures, subject matter and the kind of summary scores to be evaluated. In the end various items have been compared. These include age verses group, pupils within particular schools, levels of regional performance, important information at the national level, equitability of achievement among schools. Examples of international studies that have been done include the Programme for International Student Assessment (PISA), Trends in International Mathematics and Science Study (TIMSS), Southern and Eastern Africa Consortium for Monitoring Educational Quality (SACMEQ), Uwezo East Africa

## SECTION B

### AREA STUDIES: COMPARATIVE STUDIES OF SYSTEMS OF EDUCATION

#### DETERMINANTS OF SYSTEMS OF EDUCATION

- ❖ One of the purposes of Comparative Education is to develop general statements about the forces and factors that influence development of education systems.
- ❖ Whereas several of these factors combine and interweave to determine systems of education, some factors are often dominant in one particular system while in another system they would be less dominant.
- ❖ The factors include:
  - i) Geographical and Climatic factors
  - ii) Economic factors
  - iii) Historical factors
  - iv) Religious factors
  - v) Political factors
  - vi) Language factors
  - vii) Social-cultural factors
  - viii) Technological factors

#### **(i) Geographical factors**

- The geography of a region is in most cases natural, hence undefined by man.
- Geography influences the nature of the school system by dictating the nature of school buildings and equipment means of transport to school, age limits of compulsory school attendance etc.
- Geographical conditions influences the distribution of populations in a country i.e. scattered population in the countryside in Australia due to the desert and congregated in urban areas hence two systems of education for the two regions respectively.
- China and India with very high and densely populated has many schools within a short distance.
- The climatic conditions greatly influence the location of schools.
- Climatic conditions will affect the schooling period and vocation e.g. Australia, Kenya's North Eastern and other hot areas, schooling period starts very early and ends at afternoon.
- In Scandinavian countries, a lot of consideration is put in place to allow the learners to be at home during the winter season.
- Within the tropics, there are tropical diseases e.g. Malaria and learners exposed to the same miss out on school during the treatment period.
- Land configuration/topography i.e. hilly, plains, gentle slopping or valleys affects the type of buildings in each place.

#### **(ii) Economic factors**

- The economic factor refers to the amount or percentage of national revenue spent on education.
- The strength of the economy therefore, influences education of a country to a great extent.
- Formal education is only possible where production exceeds consumption. Economy determines the content and method of an education system.

- If the economic condition is poor, education becomes backward while if it is strong, then educational aims and the curriculum are given a special attention making the country prosperous.
- Developed countries like Britain, France, and Japan have enough grants and funds for educational programmes unlike third world countries where funds are scarce, negatively impacting on the infrastructure, teaching and learning resources.
- In developed countries, education system is patterned to make the individual graduate, strong and capable enough to stand on his or her own feet after having received education.
- Such countries afford to provide free education to all & compulsory, Universal Primary Education (UPE) and secondary education.
- In the newly industrialized countries which have middle levels of income such as Thailand, Singapore, Malaysia, Indonesia, Taiwan and South Korea, UPE is nearly achieved.
- In developed and newly developed countries, there are strict prohibitions of non-enrolments, school dropouts and low completion rates - parents of pupils who do not enrol are charged accordingly in law courts.
- Where the economy of a country is thriving, there are enough grants, minimum requirements per student are met hence the quality of education is high.
- On the other hand, the poorer classes in communities tend to be content with minimum education for their children.
- The quality of education is low where teachers are not qualified, resource materials such as books are not enough and in insufficient amounts.
- Richer classes are known to be able to keep their children longest at school because they can afford to meet the costs.
- In developing countries such as Kenya, where funds are very scarce, it affects even payment of teachers' salaries

### (iii) **Historical factors**

- Each country of the world has its own history that shapes the nations aims, aspirations, activities and destiny which is often reflected through the educational system.
- Therefore, the similarities and differences in systems of education world over have a history behind them.
- This includes:

#### (i) **Colonialism:**

- ✓ Colonialism has been an important historical factor that can be said to have shaped the education system of many African countries and others in the world.
- ✓ For example, the Berlin conference in 1815 dubbed as the scramble for Africa, later meant that; the colonies had to take up much of what was in their colonial masters' homeland and to date, features in education of these former colonial master are reflected in their former colonies.

#### (ii) **The colonial legacy:**

- ✓ In Africa colonial legacy has been a major factor in the provision of education.
- ✓ The colonies have adopted education systems their colonial masters. This has continued to affect the education system in those countries up to present.
- ✓ The colonization of Africa has left an imprint on the continent that has greatly shaped the education system in various countries.

- ✓ In this regard, the present systems of education in many countries of Africa, Asia, North and South America are actual products of past colonial influence. As such, most of these countries in their present endeavours in education represent in most cases, heroic efforts of their colonial heritage.
- ✓
- (iii) **The missionary factor:**
  - ✓ Christian missionaries in particular from Britain, France, Holland, Germany, Switzerland, and USA among others, have largely influenced the development of the education system in Africa.
- (iv) **Histories of cries of wars, epidemics, hunger, strikes:**
  - ✓ In Europe, Belgium has been a victim of repeated wars. France Napoleon Bonaparte helped to create the strong centralized and departmentalized system that hold even today.
  - ✓ He reconstructed the University and created the "Lycee" for secondary education but left the education of the masses to the churches.
- (v). **Manifest between periods in history:**
  - ✓ When attempts were made to try and bring together groups within close geographical boundaries, for example, East Africa, South Africa, West Africa and North Africa. A close look at these groups reflects features in their systems of education that tend to have similarities.

It's worthy to note that as a system grows, it builds its own history through reforms. The education system keeps on changing to address the emerging trends/needs so as to cope with current challenges and future aspirations.

(iv) **Religious factors**

- When religious beliefs are integrated in the social system, they assist an educational system e.g.
- The role of missionaries and various religious groups like catholic, protestant, Muslims etc. have all influenced features of education in the areas they occupied.
- Freedom of worship in our constitution has made people appreciate the role of religious subjects in our education
- School days from Monday to Friday and resting on Saturday and Sunday
- Some countries i.e. India, USA, Australia have both government and secular schools

(v) **Political factors**

- The politics of a country influences the extent to which policies of reform in its system of education are subjected to debate.
- Political factor dictates the kind of administration the system will have. Example includes:
- Socialism as a political philosophy advocates for the nationalization of the means of production and this can be propagated through system of education where the state is in full control.
- Countries like Mexico, Cuba and Bulgaria introduced socialist education with: monopoly of the state on education, secularism, physical and military training, political indoctrination and emphasis on science subjects.

- Nationalism- a psychological feeling to have a common outlook and traditions based on a myth of a common ancestry e.g. France
- USA pragmatism
- The racial aspect- tribe, a nation or a group of nations and this lead to British Colonial Policy, the Apartheid Policy etc.
- Policy implementation e.g. Universal Primary Education (UPE), Education for All (EFA), and Universal Higher Education (UHE) largely depends on politics. In Kenya, implementation of free primary by NARC 2003

Where democracy is practiced, it propagates education system while where dictatorship is practiced, the education system becomes a form of indoctrination. Goodwill of political power can either propagate or make the system retrogressive.

### **(vi) Language factor**

- Language is a mode of communication and it plays a key role in building the character of a nation.
- It's through the language that education is propelled.
- The language factor influences education e.g. Tanzania succeeded in literacy reforms due to use of Swahili language.
- Francophone countries are commonly former French colonies like Cameroon, Tunisia, Madagascar; Senegal etc. Anglophone like Nigeria, Ghana, Kenya, Uganda and Lusophone countries speaking Portuguese e.g. Angola, Mozambique, Guinea Bissau, Cape Verde
- Japan has fast developed due to great contribution of the use of the Japanese language in education.
- The use of foreign language will influence the extent success of the education system.

### **(vii) Social-cultural factors**

- They are customs traditions, beliefs and local developments
- Education is a social factor in the sense that any system of education must reflect the ethos of the people it is called upon to serve.
- Some cultural practices e.g. circumcision, Female Genital Mutilation (FGM), early marriages in some communities affects education.

### **(viii) Technological factors**

- Technology is one of the key drivers of education
- Modern technology has played a great role in propelling education to greater levels.
- The use of modern technology means that education is more accessible and reduces costs e.g. e-learning enable students to access learning modules for learning without necessarily going to a classroom set up. Examinations can also be done on-line where they are sent through coded messages. Students can register on-line and access information in Virtual Universities/ Open Universities, Digital Schools and Virtual programmes DISVOL, Massive Open Online Courses (MOOC)
- Large population of learners can be reached through streaming in conferences and classrooms

- Training of teachers changed where ICT has changed the role of the teacher and it's also the delivery tool.
- Improved education content-many search engines i.e. Google, Yahoo, Bing, Baidu, Ask.com. This leads to on-line journals, e-books, e-libraries, YouTube for easy storage and retrieval.
- Technology-enabled companies such as Microsoft, O'Genius Panada, Zora Robotics and class VR and the Keza company among others, towards in cooperating ICT-enabled education system where the programmes allows for the utilization of ICT and other technologies to promote transferable skills such as critical thinking, problem solving, and creativity.
- Technology-enabled teaching enhances classroom interaction and teaching pedagogy, students collaborate and easily communicate with their teachers, digital technology-enabled assessment platforms enabled teachers and students relay and receive timely feedback
- Methodology utilizing robotics improves students hands-on-engagement and activities, leading to exposure on computer programming in developing computational and logical thinking in solving real-life problems. This is accomplished by modelling problems and designing solutions (APET, 2021)
- Easing of learning Process- learning outside the schools though learning platforms Google Meet, BigBlueButton (BBB) , Zoom, Cisco webex Meeting, Adobe connect, MS Team, i Tech.world. etc,
- Variety of media and resources like animations, simulations, power-point presentations in teaching and learning process makes learning interesting and enjoyable
- Easier communication e.g. emails and websites, collaborations, joint usage of resources
- The challenge is that in most developing countries, the acquisition of modern technology is hampered by lack of finance, expertise and unwillingness on the part of the learners to embrace modern ways of acquiring education.
- 50% of schools in Sub-Saharan Africa are not connected to the grid

### Education in the United Kingdom

#### Country profile

Before 1920 UK was also known as Great Britain. In 1922, countries of Ireland seceded to become the Irish Free State. However, this did not last for long as Northern Ireland seceded from the Free State and returned to the United Kingdom. In 1927, it therefore became UK of Great Britain and Northern Ireland abbreviated as (UK). UK comprises of four geographical and historical parts: England with London capital city, Scotland with Edinburgh capital city, Wales with Cardiff as capital city and Northern Ireland with Belfast capital city.

It is located southeast of Iceland, west of Norway and Denmark, between the North Sea in the east and North Atlantic Ocean in the west. Shares maritime boarder with Belgium, Denmark, France, German, Netherlands, Norway and the Faroe islands. It occupies an area of 242, 900 square kilometers with a population of 66.8 million in 2020. The capital city is London and languages are British English, Welsh, Irish Gaelic and Scottish Gaelic. It's one of the permanent member of UN Security Council, founding member of NATO and commonwealth and left European Union (EU) in 2016 (Brexit). A map of United Kingdom is shown in Figure 1 below



### Political ideology and philosophy

- UK is a unitary state with a constitutional monarchy where Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland have a degree of autonomous devolved power.
- The head of state is the monarch king while the head of government is the prime minister. The supreme legislative body is the bicameral British parliament (House of Commons and House of Lords) sitting in Westminster Palace.
- The elementary education bill of 1870 resulted in this autonomy by establishing school boards to levy taxes and maintain elementary schools which encouraged the central government to be autonomous and secular.
- The results were the increment in school enrolment, and the introduction of compulsory elementary education by 1880.

#### **The Education Act of 1902**

- Led to a centralized system of education, with elementary, secondary and higher education (Both voluntary and state schools) put under the control of one authority where the state assumed the responsibility of education-secular education.
- **The Education Act of 1944** 'the Butler Act', after the President of the Board of Education introduced 3 stages of education, primary, secondary and further education.
- Introduced compulsory education for children aged 5-16 years within common secondary education, and the compulsory schooling.
- Across the UK, there are five stages of education; Early Years, Primary, Secondary, Further Education (FE) and Higher Education.
- Scotland, Wales, & Northern Ireland have a degree of autonomous devolved power since 1999 hence need to look at each separately.

#### **The aims of education in England**

- Learners should be educated in accordance with requirements connected with their ages, abilities and skills in order to secure their further spiritual, moral, mental and physical development.
- **The Education Act of 2002** - established a **foundation stage of education** - for children of 3-5 years
- **Stages of Education**  
**Early Years**
  - The Childcare Act of 2006 introduced The Early Years Foundation Stage (EYFS) in England (Nursery).
  - The EYFS replaced the Foundation Stage (3-5 years old), formally established in 2002.
  - Takes place in state nursery schools, nursery classes and reception classes within primary schools and privately run nurseries.
  - Children are taught the '**early learning goals**' which embrace six key areas of learning: (i) personal, social and emotional development, (ii) communication, language and literacy (iii) problem solving, reasoning and numeracy (iv) knowledge and understanding of the world (v) physical development and (vi) creative development.

### Primary education

- In England is compulsory from the age of 5 and no charge for admitting pupils to primary.

- Parents apply to any school, and if the applications are more the school governing body drafts an admission policy to explain how the available places will be given.
- Admission policies gives children who live closest to the school, children with siblings at the school, children with special needs that may be best met in the school highest priority.
- All primary schools take in pupils regardless of the ability and all primary schools are mixed sex.
- The goals of primary education are; achieving basic literacy and numeracy amongst all pupils, establishing foundations in science, mathematics and other subjects.
- Children are assessed at end of Key stage 1 and Key stage 2.

### **Secondary Education**

- Most pupils move from primary to secondary at 11 years and most secondary schools are publicly funded.
- Comprehensive schools admit without reference to ability or aptitude and cater for all children in neighborhood.
- Academies are publicly founded independent schools which benefit from greater freedoms from Local Authority (LAs), to help innovate and raise standards. The freedom include pay and conditions of staff, delivery of curriculum and ability to change length of terms and school days. They were introduced to replace poorly performing schools.
- The teachers assess their pupils work and attach to these marks their own remarks on the level of abilities of a particular pupil.
- The ultimate approval of the assessment is performed by external examiners, who determine whether the produced documents justify the assessment or not.
- At the end, pupils are entered into a range of external examinations like General Certificate of Secondary Education (GCSE)

### **Further education**

- This is post-secondary level where non-advanced courses are taken after the period of compulsory education

### **Teacher Education:**

- In teachers' training the practical aspect is emphasized, i.e. methodology of teaching and effective implementation of the educational process
- Since 1984 only higher school graduates with a professional title to teach their subject have been employed in English schools.
- Beside university degree, an English teacher has to receive a qualified teacher's license on the basis of his/her professional title and experience gained at work.
- After two years of work confirmed by positive opinions of inspectors and the headmaster, teachers gain the status of qualified teacher.

### **Administration of Education**

- Decentralized- shared by central government, local, churches, voluntary bodies.
- Public education disaggregated from 1999
- **National government-**
- National policies, planning direction of whole system

- Two ministers represent education in the cabinet (children, schools and families and business, innovation and skills)
  - **Administration at regional level-**
  - Headed by 9 regional directors
  - Work as Regional Coordination Unit (RCU)
  - Link national and local on policy

### **General administration at local Authority-**

- Executive- elected mayor, leader or cabinet
- Scrutiny committees or panels and full council of elected members  
Include representatives of Church of England and Roman Catholic Church as well representative of parents' governors.
- Chief Education Officer (CEO) changed to Director of Children's Services ( DCS)
- DCS assisted by professional education officers, advises and administrative staff
- **Functions-**
- Planning process
- Draws up the annual budget,
- Day-to-day decision on resources and priorities
- Admission policy of individual schools is determined by LA
- Ensure regular school attendance- support SNE, complaints, meals, grants, clothing, transport.
- Set term holidays
- Safety policies

### **Administration at schools**

- Administration done at schools Forum by governing bodies and head teachers
  - Governing bodies selection guided by to get balance of stakeholders
  - Include; elected parent governors, staff governors, LA, community, foundation/partnership governors

### **Role-**

- Accountable and all major decisions about schools
- Provide strategic overview
- Critical friend to the school
- Establish a written performance policy.

### **Head teacher (Principal)**

- Internal organization, management and control of schools
- Delegate the management of a specific aspect of curriculum organization, teaching method, pastoral care to senior members of teaching staff

### **Further Education Management- (FE)**

- **Governed by governing bodies (corporations)**
- Include principal, members from local business, industry or professions, coopted members, staff members, local community members
- **Functions-**Set strategic direction, mission & educational character
- Accountability
- Monitor and evaluate performance
- Appoints senior management team
- Approves annual college budget
- Day to day by principal

- No organization structure- adapt one meeting changing circumstances
- **Management of higher education**
- Self- governing/autonomous
- Governing bodies for post 1992 and councils for pre 1992
- They are diverse as laid down in charter and statutes
- External selected by nominations from business & industry, LA, staff, student, senior academic, finance director.

### Financing of Education

- Through Department for Children, Schools and Families (DCSF) and Department for Business, Innovation & Skills ( BIS)
- Provides funds to Learning and Skills Council (LSC) and Higher Education Funding Council for England (HEFCE)
- Central government provides funds to LA for education services in the local area
- BIS funds research councils which allocate public money to support research projects
- Extra funds through voluntary contributions from parents and others (Voluntary)
- IGAs i.e. renting school facilities
- Grants for specific priorities (School Development Grant)
- Public Private Partnership (PPP)
- **Funds for-** teachers, staff, books, equipment, repair & maintenance and capital expenditure

### French Education System

#### Country profile

France as a country is located in Western Europe with several islands and territories located on the other continents. Metropolitan France extends from the Mediterranean Sea to the English Channel and North Sea and from Rhyme to Atlantic Ocean. It is bordered by Belgium, Luxembourg, Germany, Switzerland, Italy and Spain. France is the largest country in a European Union area and the second largest in Europe behind Ukraine.

During the 19<sup>th</sup> century and 20<sup>th</sup> century, France built the second largest empire of the time including large portion of North, West and Central Africa, South East Asia, and many pacific islands. It's a developed country and possesses the 5<sup>th</sup> largest economy. It is the most visited country in the world, receiving 82 million foreign tourists annually. It's one of the founding members of the European Union. It's one of the five permanent members of the United Nations Security Council and possesses the 3<sup>rd</sup> largest number of nuclear weapons in the world. A map of France is shown in Figure 1 below



## Evolution of the French education system

The history of modern France is heavily influenced by the French revolution of 1789. Before the revolution, it was a feudal state (minority rulers and majority ruled) where the privileged classes enjoyed all the luxuries including education while the majority underprivileged struggled to ensure that the ruling class enjoyed.

Prior to the revolution, education was a preserve of the aristocracy (privileged and bourgeoisies) and was mainly provided by the Catholic Church. In 19<sup>th</sup> century, primary education developed slowly from parish schools. The modern era of French education begins at the end of the 19<sup>th</sup> century. A lawyer by the name Jules Ferry holding the office of minister of public instructions in 1880s is widely credited for creating the modern republican school by requiring all children under age 15 to attend school. He also made public instructions mandatory, free of charge and secular.

### Aims of French education system

- i. Promotion of social equality

- Education serves an important role of ensuring that there is social equality among the people of France.
- ii. **Promotion of human culture**  
This aim ensures that education curriculum helps to transmit the culture of freedom and respect for all.
  - iii. **Creation and cementing of unity among the French people.** Like in many countries, French educational system serves the purpose of uniting the people.
  - iv. **Transform the French society into an industrialist scientific and technological culture.** This is meant to promote the society through various technological changes as currently seen through the information communication and technological education practices.

Currently, further aims have been added to the education system in France following rapid changes in various economic sectors of French education. They are:

- v. **Reformation of higher education.**  
Currently, France has declared university education reform a priority by promising to modernize it. The main aim is to turn the universities into Centre's of research and excel in those who research so as to ensure that half of the young students pursue higher education.
- vi. **Provision of universal primary education.**  
Like in many countries, the education system in France aims at providing basic education to all its population by providing universal primary schooling.
- vii. **Quest for education tailored towards individual needs and abilities.** The education system has brought more flexibility by trying to cater for individuals abilities at different levels right from nursery school.

### Structure of French education system

The French education system is structured into three cycles.

- i. Elementary/primary
- ii. Secondary education
- iii. Higher education

### Nursery/kindergarten

Parents can send their children to kindergarten classes as early as 3 years. These nurseries are usually affiliated to a primary school. Some children begin schooling at 2 years in day care centers. The last year of kindergarten classes is an important step for the education process as it is in this year that pupils are introduced to reading. Preparation classes start at 4 Or 5 years and focus is mainly on language/ reading.

### Primary school

School attendance in France is mandatory as from 6years i.e. primary education is compulsory and lasts for 5years. It starts at age 6. It's in the 1<sup>st</sup> year that the children learn to write and develop their reading skills.

French primary school students usually have a single teacher who teachers the complete curriculum such as French language, math's, natural sciences, humanities like history and geography.

One day is set for the children to receive religious instructions. School hours and lesson duration are set by the government and are uniform for the whole country. The children are evaluated each year and those who do not qualify are not promoted to the next class.

### Secondary education

All students go for secondary schools for 4 years which are divided into two cycles of 2 years. From here, they proceed to Lycees (colleges) for the next 3 years. Junior secondary 2 years (compulsory)

In colleges, they enroll in the academic or vocational branch. Those who join the academic branch undergo a rigorous Programme leading to baccalaureate examination for entry to university. Students are tested on French language, Mathematics, Natural Sciences, History/ Geography/ Citizenship. Since the 1980s the baccalaureate has been reformed due to public demand for more young people to access higher education as well as to address each issues of relevance in education. The examinations now has 3 categories: general education, technology (ICT) and vocational knowledge

N/B elementary/primary education and the 1<sup>st</sup> cycle of secondary education are free and compulsory. Students receive a certificate of completion of compulsory education.

### **Higher education**

Higher education in France is divided into Grande 'Coles and universities. Grande 'Coles are considered more prestigious than universities. They offer professional training in engineering and business together with other prestigious professions. Grande 'Coles are small specialized institutions that offer undergraduate courses to a small group of students. They comprise about 10% of the total education enrolment. University education is taken in 3 cycles of 2 years each.

1<sup>st</sup> cycle – offers general studies for the award of university diploma. 2<sup>nd</sup> cycle leads to the 1<sup>st</sup> degree/license. 3<sup>rd</sup> cycle leads to doctorate in research.

There are about 75 universities and numerous university institutes. Higher education has no tuition costs since it's founded by the state to a great extent. Students from low income families can apply for scholarships from the government. The universities are autonomous.

### **Curriculum**

The French education system is demanding because the education of all parties involved considers the rigorous programs necessary to train enrich and broaden the mind. All parties agree that "the school is for the mind and the child had better pay attention to it"

### **Primary school curriculum**

It has the following aspects

- i. Basic instruction in French and arithmetic
- ii. Humanities like history, geography, religious instruction which are all geared towards stimulating the interest like physical, environmental, exploration, music and hard work.
- iii. Physical education and sports. There is emphasis of consultation between the parents and teachers on the kind of sport that the child should enroll in.
- iv. Counseling services are part of the curriculum. Teachers are expected to provide pastoral services and facilitate co-curriculum activities.

### **Secondary school curriculum**

Secondary school is supposed to provide a community education and also permit deepening activities for the student. Students are exposed to a common core course of basic subject which include French, a foreign language (Graded I choice according to the children's competence) math's, chemistry, biology, physics, manual education and sports. There is increased guidance and counseling to help parents, pupils and teachers to address issues that could be affecting the learners.

### **Higher education**

It's seen as a continuation after baccalaureate which is the final qualification at the end of the lycees (College). Baccalaureate has been a terribly difficult exam for many years with only 50% of candidates passing but in recent years, there has been improvement in pass rate. This has caused great pressure on the university inform of overcrowding. However, this has been reduced through creation of university colleges. In the university, a student takes 2years diploma in general studies. The 2<sup>nd</sup> cycle leads to 1<sup>st</sup> degree (License) while 3<sup>rd</sup> cycle leads to doctorate research or diploma of Grande 'Coles. The universities offers units which put together various disciplines for particular training to foster combination of humanities with others or science and technology.

Grande 'Coles are prestigious professional institutions which provide training in engineering, business and administration. The entrance to these institutions is highly competitive and requires a year of preparation beyond baccalaureate. The curriculum is standardized for all French public and private institutions. Changes to the programs are made every year by French ministry of education and published in the ministries bulletin for educators.

### **Administration**

The French education system is highly centralized unlike other developed countries and is a state responsibility. Authority is centralized in the ministry of education and through the ministry; the government is responsible for the following

- i. Designing the programs of studies for the schools including the methods of instruction.
- ii. Training of teachers
- iii. Recruitment of teachers
- iv. Paying teachers' salaries

Authority lies in the minister of national education. The country is divided into 26 educational regions called academies. Each academy is under a rector who is a professor appointed by the president. He is answerable to the minister and is responsible for all educational matters from nursery to high school. Under the rector, there are academy inspectors for each of the departments. The inspectors visit educational institutions or establishment to inspect on quality, content delivery in each academy. They ensure that educational policies are followed and that the teaching staffs are left with minor issues to attend to. At the school level, the school head teacher has been given ground and greater freedom to govern the school.

### **Financing**

1. The state provides about 67% of the total funding of the education system. This includes teachers' pay and other forms of disbursement of financial assistance such as scholarships and new school year allowance. Each year, the chief education officer receives a single sum of money for each item of expenditure which then themselves allocates to various educational establishments.
2. Local authorities provide 20% of the total educational cost.
3. The other 15% is provided by other stakeholders e.g. church.

N/B higher education is funded by the state therefore the fees are very low. Students from low income families can apply for scholarships and get a monthly allowance. Some public schools have other ways of gaining money e.g. charging a small fee for new students.

Debates are going on as the church insists that the government should fund its schools while those in favor of secular education do not want to see their money being spent on private institutions.

### Teachers

Teachers training colleges are attached to the universities and they are in 3 categories:

i. **Primary colleges which forms part of the 1<sup>st</sup> cycle.**

The training lasts for 1 year following success in a competitive examination (Pre-primary and primary). Candidates must hold a license or a 3years diploma granted within the European Union to be advised to sit for the competitive examination. In order to prepare themselves, candidates can decide to be trained in one year at an institute in the university or they can privately prepare themselves.

ii. **Training of secondary school teachers**

Colleges are attached to university and also done at secondary college which forms part of the 2<sup>nd</sup> cycle. Secondary school teachers train for one year following success in a competitive examination. Candidates must hold a license or a 3 year diploma granted within European Union or for a 4 year diploma granted outside European Union to be allowed to sit for the competitive examination. In order to prepare for themselves, candidates can decide to prepare for 1 year at an institute attached to university or privately prepare themselves hence this year of preparation is not compulsory.

iii. **Training of higher education teachers**

It is done at colleges of aggregation attached to the university and forms part of the 3<sup>rd</sup> cycle. The doctorate is pre-requisite to sit for competitive examination. The entrance exams is very competitive and focuses on the following aspects

- Sensitivity to human beings
- Mental alertness
- Exposition of issues to expound on them

This is highly emphasized as teachers play an important role in molding highly cultured citizens. A university degree is a basic requirement for secondary school teachers.

### Summary of French educational system

Despite concerted efforts to reform the education system, France has remained one of the most conservative systems since the end of the 2<sup>nd</sup> world war. This evidenced by the following:

- ✓ Overemphasis on the public school system, only about 15% of students is enrolled in private schools.
- ✓ A centralized system under the direction of the government.
- ✓ Dual system for the elites and the other for ordinary. It has been difficult to democratize the system since it is identified with different classes i.e. the halves and ordinary.
- ✓ French education system is excessively intellectual at the expense of vocational subjects.
- ✓ French educational system is highly exam oriented where by students are ruthlessly sorted out by the use of examinations. Only a small % has the entrance examinations to the most prestigious institutions.
- ✓ Through the difficult exams, the French education system is very competitive and allows only the best brains to proceed to higher education and prestigious institutions leavening out the majority with no formal training after secondary.

## Education in China

### Country profile

The people's republic of China (China) is the leading populous country with approximately 1.3 billion people with an area of approximately 9.6 square kilometers. With opening up of China to the outside world in 1970's China has become one of the world's fastest growing major economies with GDP rate of 7% to 8% second to USA, China is a permanent member of the UN Security Council. The 21<sup>st</sup> century belongs to Asia, where China leads the pack rivalling the US today in economic, social, political and technological advances



### . The following are key points for discussion

1. Educational philosophy: Chinese education system is influenced mainly by two philosophies:-

- Confucianism philosophy in education – respect for ethics, virtues and virtuous life.
  - Maotse Tung, introduced communism in 1949 when the communist party come to power in China; hence importation of Russian model of education ; polytechnic ; vocational education
  - Communism also restricted knowledge in China whose scholars did research and teaching of communist ideologies in china.
2. Structure of education in China;  
Has a structure as follows;
- Pre-school (2-3) years.
  - Primary ( 6) years
  - Junior secondary ( 3) years
  - Senior secondary ( 3 ) years
- Medium level education is mainly comprised of polytechnics- vocational education.
- Higher education comprises of junior college bachelors (min, 2 years) masters (min, 2 years) and doctorate (min, 3 years).
3. Curriculum of Chinese education system;
- The primary school curriculum consists of morality and life, Chinese language, mathematics, physical education in lower primary.
  - Higher primary courses include; morality and society, Chinese, mathematics, science, foreign language, comprehensive practical activity, physical education and art.
  - Curriculum in the junior secondary school include; morality, Chinese, mathematics, foreign language, science (Physics, Chemistry and Biology) history and society (history and geography) physical education and health, art and comprehensive practical activity.
  - Senior secondary – curriculum offer elective subjects in addition to compulsory subjects
  - Primary and secondary education comprehensive practical subject cover the following; information technology, research study, community service, social survey, labor and technology for primary and junior secondary students. They also cover research study, community service, and social practice for senior secondary school students.
4. **Organization and management of education in China.**
- Education in China is state run, managed by the ministry of education.
  - Education is developed through the five years plans e.g. the 2006 five year plan emphasized; technological, innovation and development of much talent base with creativity and self-innovation- which is geared towards economic modernization.
  - Curriculum has been broadened to more closely like that in American colleges and universities.
  - Basic education of 9 years is free and compulsory.

- Central government manages higher education while the provincial government plays key roles in basic education.
  - Ministry of education is a supreme education administration body which is responsible for policy making, regulation, planning and coordination.
5. Language of instruction is Chinese mostly with the use of English and French language in higher education in China.
6. Financing of education in China. Education in china is funded by the state through the following sources;
- I. Government appropriation; budgetary and non-budgetary funds. Expenditure on education and taxes levied for education by local government on education.
  - II. Additional financial sources for education. Tuition fees, donations and fundraising.
  - III. Private organizations and individual principal sources of funds for school run by where individual or organizations.
- 7 .Teaching and teachers in China
- Teaching is respected profession in China.
  - Annual teacher's day since 1985.
  - In 1986, law on compulsory education stated in the entire society should respect teachers teach law passed in 1993 codified protection for teacher rights and stated their responsibilities.
  - In terms of pay teachers are moderately paid, their jobs are stable with good benefits.
  - China has about 15 million full time teachers primary 5.6 million secondary 3.5 million 5.9 million for pre-school and higher education.
8. Current trends in Chinese Education systems.
- Globalization has influenced Chinese education where international community has influenced Chinese education and also china has influenced education of other countries in Chinese, technical education, research among others.
  - Currently, china is reforming its education system, has increased funding for the sector concentrated more on vocational education and given autonomy to the sector.
  - Chinese spending on research, education science and innovation has highly increased.

Compare and contrast the above points between Chinese and USA education.  $2 \times 9 = (18 \text{ marks})$

### Summary- Chinese Education

- In primary education emphasis was on equal while secondary education emphasis on technical and vocational education.
- Tertiary /higher education is being explained modernized, restructured and diversified.
- The Chinese education is on the right path but there are a few challenges such as;-
- Bureaucratization, double command lack of coordination, tension between political and professional agencies is a real monster in Chinese education.

### Education in Japan

#### Country profile

Japan occupies a chain of Islands in East Asia in the North Pacific Ocean. The archipelago stretches from south of the Russian Sakhalin island in the north to near Taiwan in the southwest. The main islands are Hokkaido, Honshu, Shikoku, and Kyushu. It shares maritime borders with China, North Korea, South Korea, the Philippines, Russia, and Taiwan. It occupies an area of 377,915 square kilometers. Japan is the 10<sup>th</sup> largest country in the world by population with 127 million citizens in 2021. It has the world's largest life expectancy of 83.2 years. However, it is experiencing a slow shrinking population as the population of older people is rising. Its capital city is Tokyo and the official language is Japanese. A map of Japan is shown in Figure 6 below



### Education in Singapore

#### Country profile

Singapore city-state is located at the southern tip of the Malay Peninsula, bordering the Strait of Malacca to the west, the Singapore Strait to the south, the South China Sea to the east and the Straits of Johor to the north. It shares maritime borders with Malaysia and Indonesia. Singapore occupies an area of 734.3 square kilometers with a population of 5.7 million people in 2021 which is multi-racial in composition due to considerable past immigration. The diverse population has led to four official languages namely; English which is lingua franca, Mandarin, Malay and Tamil. Its capital city is Singapore and is also the largest port in Southeast Asia. Singapore is a vibrant global hub of trade, finance and transportation and its transformation from third world to first world in one generation is one of Asia's great stories. The economic development is dependent on capital market investments with multinational corporations and not on production and export of commodities. Majority profess Confucianism, Buddhism or Taoism and Islam. Christianity has equally grown rapidly in the recent times. A map of Singapore is shown in Figure 6 below



Singapore stellar academic performance in international assessments like Trends in International Mathematics and Science Study (TIMSS) and Programme for International Student Assessment (PISA) for reading, Mathematics and Science is attributed to effective school system, well run schools, highly qualified teachers and resilient students (Tan *et al*, 2016)

### **Political ideology and philosophy of education**

Singapore was once a British colony before joining the Federation of Malaysian in 1963. It seceded the federation to become independent state in 1965 with Lee Kuan Yew as the president. It's a unitary parliamentary democracy based on Westminster model and every adult citizen is registered voter where voting is compulsory. People's Action Party (PAP) has dominated Singaporean policies and has promoted a national paternalistic ideology. The ideology emphasizes a rigid public morality focused on personal appearance and cleanness, political loyalty and family planning. In order to respond to the emerged knowledge – based economy paradigm, Singapore developed “Thinking Schools, Learning Nation” (TSLN) education philosophy. “Thinking Schools” ought to develop learner's creative and critical thinking, skills and a passion for lifelong learning. “Learning Nation” ought to place education at the heart of national identity. Diversity of talents, be it the intellect, the arts, sports, or community endeavors, is treasured and developed in all students based on their interests and potential (Tan *et al*, 2016). The Framework for 21<sup>st</sup> Century Competences and Student Outcomes (21st Framework) guided the development of subject syllabi and instructional materials. The core values identified are critical and inventive thinking; communication, collaboration and information skills; civil literacy, global awareness and cross-cultural skills. Schools are expected to offer a range of learning experiences to develop students holistically and all students to participate in Values-in Action programmes that help to build a sense of social responsibility towards their community. “Teach Less, Learn More” (TLLM) philosophy has shifted the role of the teacher who is no longer an expert and dispenser of content but rather a resource person to facilitate the students learning through creative and student centered activities.

### **Structure of education system**

The system is highly valued and elaborately structured with the following levels; Pre-primary, Primary, Secondary, Pre-university and University.

#### **Pre- schools/ Kindergarten**

- They are government or private institutions which enroll children at age 4-6 years.

The level provide children with opportunities to build their self-confidence, learn social skills and develop learning dispositions.

#### **Curriculum**

- Basic literacy and numeracy skills
- Bilingualism where English language is taught and Mother Tongue Language (MTL) which is either Mandarin, Malay or Tamil.

Several measures have been undertaken to improve the level and they include;

- (i) Developing curriculum resources to support educators in designing quality learning experiences.
- (ii) Providing quality and affordable pre-school education through MOE Kindergarten.
- (iii) Shared curriculum resources and other good practices with pre-school sector.
- (iv) Raising the standards of teacher training and qualifications, reviewing the regulatory framework of kindergarten.
- (v) Curriculum resources provided like planning guide with sample lesson plans.

(vi) Provision of grants to non-profit pre-schools to purchase teaching and learning resources like books and educational software.

(vii) Provision of innovation grants

### **Primary education Grade 1 to 6**

- Children start primary school at age 7 and primary is compulsory for all Singaporeans.
- It lasts for 6 years designed to give a strong educational foundation
- End of primary 6, students sit for terminal Primary School Leaving Examination (PSLE) which assess the suitability for secondary education and place them in a secondary school course that matches their learning pace, ability and inclinations.

Exceptions are given to children with special needs, those attending a designated school like Islamic religious school or those in home-schooling.

### **Curriculum**

Content focuses on English language, Mother Tongue Language (MTL), Mathematics, Science. Learners are encouraged to participate in Co-Curricular Activities (CCAs) like Sports and Music, Community Involvement Programme (CIP) like in- service learning projects.

### **Secondary school Grade 7 and 8**

- Lasts for four or five years depending with the track

### **Tracks at the secondary school**

- I. Express- 4 years express secondary schools
- II. Normal (Academic)- 5 years (normal academy) for those who need slightly more years at secondary school
- III. Normal (Technical)- 5 years (normal technical) for those who need slightly more years in vocational secondary school
- IV. Special track for those with special needs
  - Admission to secondary school is based on students' diverse strengths and interests in areas such as arts and sports following performance in PSLE

At the end, students sit for a national examination General Certificate of Education "Ordinary Level (GCE "O" Levels).

### **Curriculum**

A broad –based education in Languages, Humanities and Arts, Mathematics and Sciences, Design and Technology, Physical Education, Character and Citizenship Education.

### **Pre- university**

- Almost all students proceed to one of the following post-secondary education institutions
  - (i) Junior colleges/ centralized institutions- offer an academic pre-university course 2 to 3 years
  - (ii) Polytechnics- offer three-year, practice oriented diploma courses that equip students with industry- relevant skills. Most of the polytechnic graduates progress to work as a proportion of them more on to University education
  - (iii) The Institute of Technical Education ( ITE), which offers a broad-based, multidisciplinary curriculum including engineering, technical, business and service skills
  - (iv) Arts Institutions for students interested in the creative arts
- At the end, they sit for General Certificate of Education Advanced Level (GCE "A" Level Examination.

### Curriculum

- All students learn two languages, Social Studies and Mathematics and select from a wide range of elective subjects and programmes.

### University

- There are both public and private Universities in Singapore
- 30% enroll into government- funded, autonomous, local Universities e.g. Singapore University of Technology and Design

### Lessons

- (i) Introduction of bilingualism- proficiency in any two languages but proficiency in English language and Mother Tongue Language (MTL) (Chinese/mandarin for Chinese, Malay for Malaysians and Tamil for Indians. MTL takes care of the diverse population in Singapore while English is the language of globalization
- (ii) More pathways for students, with the goals of improving the quality of education, reducing dropout rates and developing the skills required in the new capitals and skill-intensive economy.
- (iii) Offering different courses in schools, with differentiated curriculum and pedagogical approaches designed to enable more students to progress through secondary schools and post-secondary institutions.
- (iv) Integrated Programme (IP) allow students to skip their “O” level examination and move directly to junior college curriculum.
- (v) To respond to the knowledge-based economy paradigm, “Thinking Schools, Learning Nation” (TSLN), philosophy was developed with aim of developing creative and critical thinking skills and a passion for lifelong learning, a move from rote memorization of content knowledge and low-level thinking skills. At post-secondary level, new subjects like Knowledge and Inquiry (KI) have been introduced with aim of imbuing students with a spirit of learning and exploration through developing the mental capacity to question and seek answers to observations and phenomena.
- (vi) Flexibility and variety in school systems. The curriculum reduced following “Teach Less Learn More” (TLLM) with aim of creating space for more inquiry based activities.
- (vii) Science curriculum is centered on the spirit of scientific enquiry and is based on three domains essential to the practice of science; knowledge, understanding and application; skills and processes; and ethics and attitudes. Quality of vocational education was enhanced.
- (viii) The Institute of Technical Education (ITE) provided high-quality technical and vocational education.
- (ix) Industries helped develop the ITE with the aim of providing graduates with the industry-relevant skills.
- (x) Universities and polytechnics expanded to train a larger number of scientists and engineers hence meeting the demands of more technologically driven economy.

### Administration

- Administration of education in Singapore is centralized where the Ministry of Education (MOE) controls, administers, implements and formulates policies of the entire education system starting from primary level till University education.
- The minister of education is aided by a minister of state, parliamentary secretary and a ministry of education permanent secretary.

- Under the permanent secretary is the Director of Education who coordinates all the academic and professional aspects.

### Funding

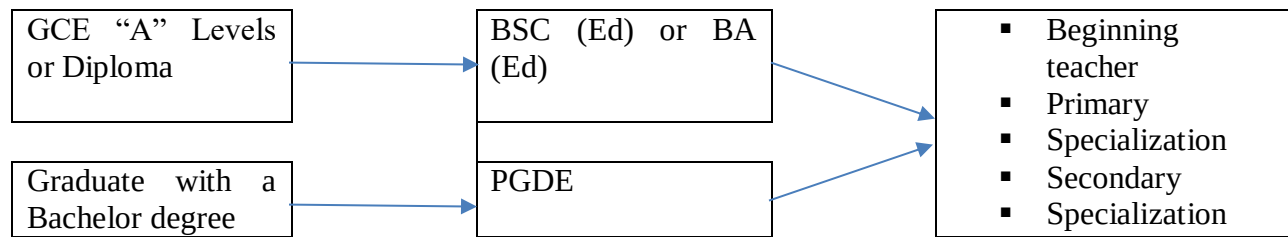
- Funding of education is done by the government, private agencies or private methods.
- The bulk of the national expenditure up to 25% is in education and the funds are obtained from the general revenues.
- Schools and universities are encouraged to raise funds particularly for capital expenditure like construction of buildings or major facilities.
- Pre- school is subsidized by the state up to 50 per cent of the cost
- Primary education is free and compulsory while nominal fee is paid for secondary schools and junior colleges.
- Universities and HEIs prepare their own budgets and submit to the MOE where they receive block grants annually for their expenditure.
- Sponsorship, scholarships, bursaries, education loans, aids and grants and part time jobs are available from the MOE to those who cannot afford the cost.

### Teacher education

- The foundation to the nation's educational success was its focus on the quality of its teachers.
- The TSLN, TLLM and ICT Master Plans initiatives lead to National Institute of Education (NIE) establishment as an institute of Nanyang Technological University (Gopinathan & Loh, 2023).
- NIE is the nation's foremost teacher education provider, with programmes catering for pre-service teacher education and postgraduate professional development and therefore, all teachers must go through NIE in order to be certified to teach.
- Tripartite partnership of MOE, NIE and Schools have shared goals and purpose, mutual respect and commitment. The three agents have equal status and responsibility where they mutually communicate and make new programmes to attain the shared goals while each party executes their own responsibility ( Jang, 2023)
- Training of teachers is guided by Teacher Education Model for the 21<sup>st</sup> Century (TE21) frame work (V3SK).
- The attributes of the TE21 teaching profession under V3SK model are **values** of learner centeredness, teacher identity, service to professional and community. **Skills** required by the educator and in-depth subject matter **knowledge**. Therefore, V3SK articulates the values, skills and knowledge needed for teaching profession.
- The TE21 aims at preparing teachers for heterogeneous student population and emphasizes experiential and participatory learning, autonomous thinking profession to perform multiple roles like knowledge organizer, motivator, facilitator, co-inquirer and designer of the learning process ( Rajandriran, 2021)

### Entry requirements

- The deployment of graduates in the teaching service is a deliberate one to ensure that only the best of each cohort students are chosen to become teachers.
- Entry requirement to pre-service teacher training include;
  - a. Those with University degree- enter Post Graduate Diploma in Education (PGDE) for 16 weeks.
  - b. Fresh school leavers with GCE "A" Levels or International Baccalaureate (IB) enroll for 4 years Bachelor of Arts (Ed) or Bachelor of Science (Ed) program.



- Figure 2 above implies that primary and secondary schools teachers have bachelors or post graduate qualifications.

### Admission criteria

- The admission criteria into initial teacher education is a highly selective process where candidates selected must be from among the top 30 per cent of their age cohort.
- Application CVs are screened for appropriate coursework and qualification and evidence of interest in education.
- Shortlisted candidates are tested by MOE and interviewed by panels of experienced principals where aptitude, communication skills, passion for education, potential to be a good role model are considered. Normally, out of every 3 candidates shortlisted, one qualifies ( Tan, *et al*, 2018)
- The highly selective admission criteria, commitment for education research elevated academic qualifications for its students and has enabled the profession to attract a better caliber of teacher-students.

### Structure of the training

- All initial teacher preparation programmes include a compulsory practicum component in addition to theory-based classes where real classroom teaching practice and microteaching component are included in all curriculum courses.
- The teacher training offers considerable clinical experience in the form of practicums which takes 20 per cent of BA (Ed) or BSC (Ed) programme and 35 per cent of PGDE programme.
- PGDE have 4 weeks observation in school and 10 week practicum in schools at end of the course while for BA (Ed) and BSC (Ed) have one week observation in schools in year two, five weeks practicum in year three and 10 weeks final practicum at the end of the course.
- There is increased opportunities for international practicum exchanges, in partnership with reputed Universities and schools abroad for students to build greater depth in pedagogical approaches in different cultural and social settings.
- Allocation of the schools is done by the MOE based on school request and teachers are mentored by senior teachers and supervisors from NIE.
- NIE introduced a course called Professional Practice and Inquiry (PPI) course to allow pre-service teachers to formulate their own teaching philosophies. PPI is a space for pre-service teachers to identify and reflect on the values of teaching and learning through the use of learning e-portfolio.
- e-portfolio is an electronic collection of authentic and diverse evidence of a student teacher learning and achievement over time, on which they have reflected and designed for personal development as well as for presentation to audiences for specific purposes.

- e-portfolio serves to document student teachers growth and development of their personal teaching philosophies, capacities and competencies over the course of their pre-service preparation.
- NIE creates experiential learning package using field work whenever possible, excursions and field trips.
- Expansion of postgraduate education programmes where the Centre for Research in Pedagogy and Practice (CRPP) was established to design and implement evidence-based teacher education reforms specific to Singapore unique educational context and recruit faculty with postgraduate qualifications (Gopinathan & Loh, 2023).
- NIEs Initial Teacher Preparation (ITP) and PGDE programmes incorporate Singapore context-specific 21<sup>st</sup> century teacher competencies in their graduate criteria, Graduated Teachers Competencies (GTCs). The aim is to bridge the gap between theory and practice within the teacher education by strengthening the theory-practice nexus.
- After graduating, all beginning teachers are inducted, a process centrally managed by MOE.
- Induction helps transition teachers from pre-service to in-service professional learning for mentoring teachers, professional development and appraisal and career ladder.
- Prioritized beginning teacher development through mentoring system and reduced workload
- Seamless transition to teacher professional development and lifelong opportunities where teachers can constantly upgrade their skills.
- Continued funding from MOE for teachers to go to NIE and the professional development is designed to build on the existing knowledge base that pre-service teachers have learnt.
- The career pathways include;
  - (i) Teaching track
  - (ii) Leadership track
  - (iii) Senior specialist track.
- Teachers provided with opportunities for designing, implementing and studying new or improved teaching and learning approaches, and in curriculum design, pedagogy and assessment.
- Teachers provided with more time to prepare, reflect on and share ideas to make teaching more responsive to student's needs, and systematic teacher support such as professional collaborations and diverse career trajectories ( Teacher Growth Model) through new teacher programmes to support well-established existing professional platforms such as school-based collaborative programmes, professional learning communities and inter-school level communities.
- Support teachers through reduced administrative workload and promotion based on merit and professional growth.

### **Status of teaching profession in Singapore**

Teaching is a highly attractive profession due to;

- (i) Starting salaries for teachers are comparable to others in civil service
- (ii) Tuition for teacher education students is free
- (iii) Pre-service teachers receive a salary while preparing to become teachers
- (iv) Secured positions after graduating
- (v) Career ladder that suits diversified aspirations

- (vi) High social status and respect from the Singapore public
- (vii) Availability of scholarship and study leave

### Lessons

- a) Seamless transition of pre-service teacher education to continuing professional development enables teachers to keep abreast of changing educational innovations
- b) Prospective teachers undergo a stringent selection process before they are admitted to the national institute of education for their pre-service education
- c) Government support, resource availability, high quality professional development opportunities responsive to changes in educational landscape
- d) Structures to allow planning and tracking of professional development.
- e) Development of a culture of continual improvement, and open and collaborative school environment (Tripartite partnership) MOE, NIE and Schools like;
  - a. On pedagogy, common time created for teachers to collaborate on planning lessons and active learning activities for students.
  - b. Timetabled time known as “white space” for teachers to engage in professional planning, reflection and sharing.
  - c. “Teach Less, Learn More” (TLLM) philosophy shifted the role of the teacher from being an expert and dispenser of content knowledge to a resource person to facilitate the student learning through creative and student centered activities.
  - d. Significant investments in ICT to facilitate new modalities of learning
  - e. Organizing schools around clusters of 10 to 14 for collegial sharing leading to innovative programming and teaching.
  - f. Alternative forms of assessment- formative, authentic and school-based assessments have become viable alternatives.

### Challenges

- (i) Due to internationalization, denationalisation of economies, weakening of nation state and commodification of education as a result of globalization, there is increasing cultural diversity hence need to adopt multicultural approach in its organizational strategies, management structures and practices in teaching and learning.
- (ii) Increasing geopolitical uncertainty exacerbated by the COVID-19 crisis
- (iii) Rapidly changing economy where the demand for skills is dynamic and short-lived
- (iv) Risks of exacerbating social divide from a population with increasingly diverse aspirations
- (v) Managing education strategies that support a diversity of pathways with diverse skillsets that meet changing economic needs
- (vi) Classroom teaching continued to prioritize examinable subjects over holistic education and formal assessments over other measures of learning. Lessons rarely encouraged passionate pursuit of knowledge, higher-order thinking or open-ended interaction
- (vii) Students mental wellness
- (viii) Racial and class disparities in students achievements
- (ix) Teachers over-taxation, poor working life balance and face undue stress due to unclear boundaries and non-uniform performance appraisal grading across different schools

### EDUCATION IN USA

#### Country profile



- a) The USA has a population of about 300 million people. It has about 95% enrolment in primary school, about 90% enrolment in secondary school and 83% in tertiary education. Government spending on education stands at 15.3%. After the collapse of the former USSR, the USA has remained the major super power in the contemporary world. Education has played a significant role in the rise of the USA to be the world's major economic and technological power. This advancement gives the USA a dominant position on most global issues.

- b) **Educational philosophy** American education was largely an offshoot of European education especially influenced by the views of Herbert Spencer. Special emphasis was placed on the sciences. USA leads in opening up the education system to most of its people and would like to be the first in the world in Mathematics and Science achievement. The overall theory or philosophy is pragmatism and is based on problem solving.
- c) **Structure, management and financing. Structure**, the USA has one of the most diverse education systems in the world. The American education system is decentralized. There is no national system, curriculum or governing law. Each of the 50 states controls their own education systems i.e structure of the system, curriculum, accreditation, funding and examination.
- d) **Structure of education**
  - i) Primary school generally takes between 5 to 6 years while
  - ii) Secondary school takes between 3 to 4 years.
  - iii) The higher education system is not legally organized into separate university and non-university systems, but is comprehensive. It is a diverse and autonomous community of public and private institutions.

US accreditation policies require adherence to certain minimum standards at each level. The higher education system is composed of about 3,501 universities, leading in research and innovation and characterized by accessibility.

**Current trends Education in the USA** still holds the pragmatic view.

- a) It has influenced many world education systems especially due to its diversity and success.
- b) Today it is the largest center for knowledge generation and utilization and leads in scholarship in almost all disciplines.
- c) It has developed tremendous scientific discoveries, developed the economy, solved pressing social problems and ensured cultural vitality.
- d) It has provided tremendous opportunities for social and economic mobility and enabled diverse people to realize their dreams.

### **Challenges of education in USA**

Even though the US system has attained much success, it faces lots of internal challenges including

- i) Quality, equity especially for minorities, low achievement in science and maths compared with other countries.
- ii) The US is also losing its historic edge in educational attainment with increasing dropout rates and with the disadvantaged and low achieving students' getting poor education.

iii) This could be worse due to budgetary cuts on education and rising tuition costs.

iv) USA is also facing declining international competitiveness of its system.

**Education Reforms in USA;** Currently due to competition from other countries, mainly Japan and China, America is realigning its education system more towards the needs of the new knowledge economy.

There is a lot of focus on improving teaching, equity, and quality of schools.

The states mandate to educate all children remains important but the world into which they will go has changed greatly.

Since the US can no longer compete China and India in quantity, it will have to compete in quality and pragmatism of its system. In relation to Africa, the USA has heavily funded and supported education in Africa and is still one of the leading supporters of education in Africa.

### **Summary of Education in USA:**

1. By tradition and constitutional arrangement education has always been a function of the individual states and local institutions.
2. A great portion of expenditure is borne by the local population.
3. The spirit of democracy dominates all spheres of life including education.
4. The public schools are all secular.
5. Educational programmes are diversified. The high school students are offered a wide choice among courses which prepare for industrial jobs, for general college or for technical courses.

The philanthropic foundations have played an important role in American education.

### Education in Cuba

#### Country profile

The Archipelago lies west of the northern Caribbean Sea, east of the Gulf of Mexico and west of the Atlantic Ocean. Cuba is located south of the eastern United States and the Bahamas, west of the Turks and Caicos Islands and Haiti, east of Mexico, and north of Cayman Islands and Jamaica. Republic of Cuba consists of island of Cuba, the Isle of Youth and more than 1600 adjacent keys and small islands. It occupies an area of 109,884 square kilometers with a population of 11.3 million people in 2021. Its capital city is Havana and the official language is Spanish. Its economy mainly relies on plantation agriculture, exporting sugarcane, coffee, tobacco, rice, citrus fruits, potatoes, plantains, bananas, cassava, tomatoes and corn. Cuba gained formal independence in 1902 from Spain and in 1959, Fidel Castro and his guerrillas entered Havana triumphantly overthrowing Dictator Fulgencio Batista. Consequently, Cuba severed its diplomatic relations with US and turned to Soviet Union for support. It's a socialist state where Communist Party is described as the "Vanguard of Cuban nation". No opposition parties are legally recognized. The 1992 constitution redefined Cuba as a secular state that recognizes the right of citizens to freedom of religion. However, the government engages in active efforts to control and monitor religious institutions. A map of Cuba is shown in Figure 1 below



### **Political philosophy**

- The Marxist dogma replaced Cuba's philosophy as a major component of the 1959 revolutions effort to create a new socialist man.
- In 1961, there were literacy campaigns by mobilizing the masses and opening up of schools for revolutionary instruction.
- Many students were sent to communist countries to study Marxism-Leninism and its corresponding pedagogy
- Man and socialism provided the guiding principle of educational policy quest

### **Political value of education**

- Education as the main pathway to development
- Education of citizens as a major tool to shape society at large
- Education as the tool for citizen to interpret their societies
- The level and quality of education as a major factor for people's engagement in political process.

### **Basic ideas of the system**

- Education as a right
- Education is public and free at all levels
- Access should be a function of capacity and interest, not of social background or financial situation
- Studying and working as integral parts of education
- Education is intended to provide the broadest possible understanding of reality
- Education include political, and social sciences, philosophy and political economy for all students

### **Structure**

#### **Pre-primary**

- Enrolment is voluntary in formal day care facilities
- Mainly targets working mothers and although it's not compulsory, almost all children in the typical age range attended formal or informal institutions

#### **Primary school (Grade- 1-6)**

- Its compulsory for age 6 to 11
- Its divided into two cycles of grade 1-4 and grade 5-6
- Assessment is conducted on school- by – school basis where first cycle is qualitative i.e. excellent to insufficient while second cycle assessed out of 100% and the pass grade is 60%
- Analogous special needs facilities and services staffed are offered by education and healthcare professionals

#### **Lower school (Grade7-9)**

- Admit at age 12 and children automatically gain attendance after graduating from grade 6
- Graduation from 9<sup>th</sup> grade marks end of compulsory education at age 15

#### **Upper secondary education/ vocational/trade schools grade (10-12)**

- There are two tracks that is pre-university education (2 Years) and upper secondary vocational/trade schools (4 years)

- At end of grade 12, students are awarded the title bachiller and may take entrance enter into a programme at university or entry entrance to short programmes (daily programmes).
- Graduates of the 12<sup>th</sup> pre-university graduate who are unable to enter university may enter vocational school instead where training is shorten for two years

### **Post-secondary and higher education (minimum of years)**

- About 22.2 % of Cuba's working population have a university degree
- Higher education include; universities, higher institutes, colleges and independent facilities
- From pre-university secondary school joins university for bachelor's degree
- Admission is based on quotas according to state needs and distributed across areas like engineering, natural sciences and humanities
- Although restrictions to enter universities were loosened to allow for greater access to higher education, entrance examinations were reintroduced in 2010 were half of marks are generated from entrance examinations while the other half obtained from mean of students grades during all three years of pre-university education
- As a way of paying back to the society, one needs to provide evidence of military service and also need to be approved by revolution committee in order to demonstrate that you understand the political philosophy.
- This action was meant to reduce university enrolment.

### **Curriculum**

Curriculum is largely socialism based

#### **Primary and secondary**

- Physical artistic and environmental education
- Heath education and hygiene
- Labor education (handcrafts, woodwork, home economics, agricultural activities
- Pioneer activities like camping
- Cuban history
- Native language
- Effort made to keep the number per classroom at 20

#### **Upper secondary**

- STEM focus
- Traditional subjects
- Ideological education ( principal of Marxism-Leninism
- Military training

### **University**

- More numbers are admitted in education, health, engineering, economics and social sciences and humanities.

### **Administration**

- Education is one of Cuba's key pillar as well as a vital commitment of the state to its society
- There is a close coordination between the policies and strategies are implemented by the state.
- Ministry of education under the state has a duty of managing, guiding and controlling education at all levels thus highly centralized
- At school levels, the parents and teachers are involved in the day to day running

### **Financing**

- Education is entirely financed by the state and organized and administered by the ministry of education
- All education is free of charge for Cuban citizens including universities
- Cuba has been allocating a higher per cent of its GDP to education in comparison to the world average and Latin America average.
- Education budget is utilized for educational services (professors, administration, methodology)
- Educational materials (Pencils, notebooks, workbooks), uniform, infrastructure, feeding in some cases, transportation especially special education

### **Teacher education**

- Teachers are trained at Higher Institutes of Educational Sciences which are either separate from universities or integrated into regular universities
- Institutes offer a five year programme for teacher in all areas of education including Marxist-Leninism philosophy and creativity
- Teachers are deployed to pre-schools through upper secondary
- In addition to universities, future teachers receive part of their practical training in nearby Schools (Teacher mentors)
- Teachers also receive in-service training
- Few teachers are produced with yearly unmet quotas due to insufficient flow of aspiring teachers as veteran teachers have left due to opening tourism sector to recuperate economic losses sustained after fall of Soviet Union.
- Teachers opted to private sector/self-employment because salaries were not competitive hence untrained teachers are being used as a short-term solution

### **Uniqueness about teaching**

- Teacher learning groups for every discipline at each school
- Teachers conduct independent research
- Promotional tracks for educators leaving to management position in municipal education
- Regular evaluation of teachers and students performance
- Possibility of dismissal in case of poor results

### **Continuing education (adult education)**

- Members of workforce who either left the school system earlier or wishes to continue their studies in general education have four options;
- Work- peasant education-elementary
- Secondary worker- peasant education- secondary
- Worker peasant college-college
- Foreign language schools
- Modalities range from evening courses to more intense programmes

### **Characteristics of the system**

- Universal school enrollment and attendance

- Nearly universal adult literacy
- Proportional female representation at all levels including higher education
- Strong scientific training base, particularly in chemistry and medicine
- Consistent pedagogical quality across widely dispersed classroom
- Equality of basic educational opportunities even in impoverished areas both rural and urban
- Latin America, it ranks the best grades among both males and females

### Education in South Africa

#### Country profile

- South Africa is the southernmost country on African continent with a population of 60M by 2021.
- It is a multi-ethnic, cultural and racial diversity with black Africans, Afrikaners (descendants from Dutch settlers), Indians and Asian heritage.
- It has a constitutional democracy which comprises a parliamentary republic and nine provinces and governed by ANC
- It's governed from three official capitals namely Pretoria (administrative), Bloemfontein (Judicial) and Cape Town (legislative). The largest city is Johannesburg.
- The main languages are: Afrikaans, English, Ndebele, Pedi, Sotho, Swazi, Tsonga, Tswana, Venda, Xhosa, and Zulu.
- The main religions are Christianity, Islam, Hinduism, Judaism and indigenous religions.

South Africa is an upper-middle income country and one of the largest economies on the continent and the world's leader in mining and minerals producing 90% platinum metals and 41% gold, although it still experiences poverty, crime and unemployment. Figure 1 below shows the map of South Africa



### Objectives of education

- South Africa had a turbulent history characterized by apartheid and with its abolition in 1994; a significant gap in education standards between the rich and poor communities was evident.
- Creation of a non-racial, non-sexist, democratic South Africa presents a challenge to everybody in the country.
- South African Schools Act of 1996 aimed at promoting access to education, promotion of quality and democratic governance in the schooling system and makes schooling compulsory for children aged 7 to 15 to ensure that all learners have access to quality education without discrimination
- The country implemented Outcomes Based Education (OBE) with the aim of nurturing of independent and critical thinking

### Structure of education

- The structure reflects colonial legacy
- It has a 3 tier education system of primary, secondary and higher education

### Pre-school

- Comprises of voluntary education offered at kindergartens for age 3 to 7 years ( Grade 0 or reception)
- ECD programme aims to guide kindergarteners in teaching young children and also to encourage more children into Early Years Education(EYE)

### **General Education and Training (GET)**

- Compulsory from Grade 0 to Grade 9)

### **Primary education**

- Duration of 6 years
- National Qualification Framework: Level 1
- General Education and Training Certificate awarded
- Six years are spend at primary schools

### **GET phases**

- a. Foundation phase-Grade 0 to grade 3
  - Junior primary schools
  - Compulsory
  - Learn to read, write and calculate in their own languages
- b. Intermediate phase-Grade 4 to 6
  - Senior primary schools
  - Develop practical skills and deepen the knowledge gained at foundation phase.
  - Learn history, geography and general science
  - Lessons are taught in the official language of the province and English is mandatory
  - Class sizes range from 30 to 50 pupils in poorer areas
- c. Senior phase- Grade 7-9
  - Secondary schools operate at this phase
  - Art, Mathematics, Technology, Languages, Natural sciences, business, management and humanities

### **Further Education and Training (FET) Grade 10-12**

- Senior secondary schools
- National Qualification Framework Level 2-4
- Learners take public examination in 6 subjects to get senior certificate
- One can choose to leave education in grade 9 or continue and take matriculation examinations necessary to gain entry into university
- Curriculum includes languages, mathematics, sciences, technology, business, and management and humanities

### **Higher Education and Training**

- Universities are divided into; traditional Universities which are academic in nature, technology Universities which offer vocational courses and comprehensive Universities that offer both types of courses
- Programmes at technology Universities are more professional than those at Universities
- A bachelor's degree takes a minimum of three years to complete and admission is by completion of secondary school (matriculation)
- Universities offers bachelor degree, Honors Degree, Master Degree, Doctorate Degree, Diploma and Certificate
- Emphasis is on medicine, engineering and research
- National Qualification Framework Level 5-8

### **Funding of education**

- Pre-school public institutions are funded and regulated by Department of Basic education
- Mostly subjugated by the private sector and church related pre-schools
- Fees is paid in both public and private institutions
- Primary and secondary school sector is divided into ; non-fee paying public schools, fee paying public schools and private schools
- Public non-fee paying schools are available in poorest areas and are completely subsidized by government
- Public fee-paying schools are subsidized by government but parents contribute annual fee.
- Private (independent) fee paying fees.
- Universities are publicly funded but students are charged annual tuition fees
- There is huge investment in Universities making Universities more accessible to poorer students and significantly improving quality thereby competing on the world stage
- National Student Financial Aid scheme distributes students loans and bursaries
- There is a tax break that encourages private companies to partner with universities in research activities.

### **Administration**

- Pre-schools, primary and secondary schools are overseen by Department of Basic Education (DBE)
- Each of the 9 provinces have their own education departments and budgets
- Department of Higher Education and Training ( DHET) is in charge of tertiary and vocational training

### **Teacher training**

- Teacher training traditionally provided at Teacher-Training Colleges located in the provinces
- National Department of education and various Universities coordinates the training
- Those who wish to teach at primary schools needs a diploma while those in secondary schools have bachelor's degree.
- There are two routes i.e. four-year bachelor of education degree (B.Ed.) or 3 to four year bachelor degree followed by one-year Postgraduate Certificate in Education (PGCE)
- Professionally qualified teachers are registered with South African Council of Educators (SACE)
- The phases of specialization are Foundation phase Grade R-3, Intermediate phase Grade 4-6, Senior phase Grade 7-9 and Further Education and Training FET Grade 10-12
- Higher education Institutions (HEIs) allows a combinations of phases of specialization like intermediate, senior and FET
- Teaching is professionalized through: Initial Teacher Training (ITE), induction, Registration of teachers, Continuing Professional Development (CPD) and evaluation of teachers performance
- Employment of Educators Act of 1998 regulates the professional, moral and ethical responsibilities of educators, and competency requirements for teachers
- Heterogeneous population structure with plurality of value systems, makes teacher education and training very complex

### **Continuing education**

- Under apartheid, education was inaccessible to the majority especially higher education

- Continuing Education and Training Act of 2006 aims at promoting equity through continuing and lifelong learning thus widening access and promoting programmes that develop broadly applicable abilities such as computer literacy and problem solving skills leading to economic competitiveness and personal empowerment of learners

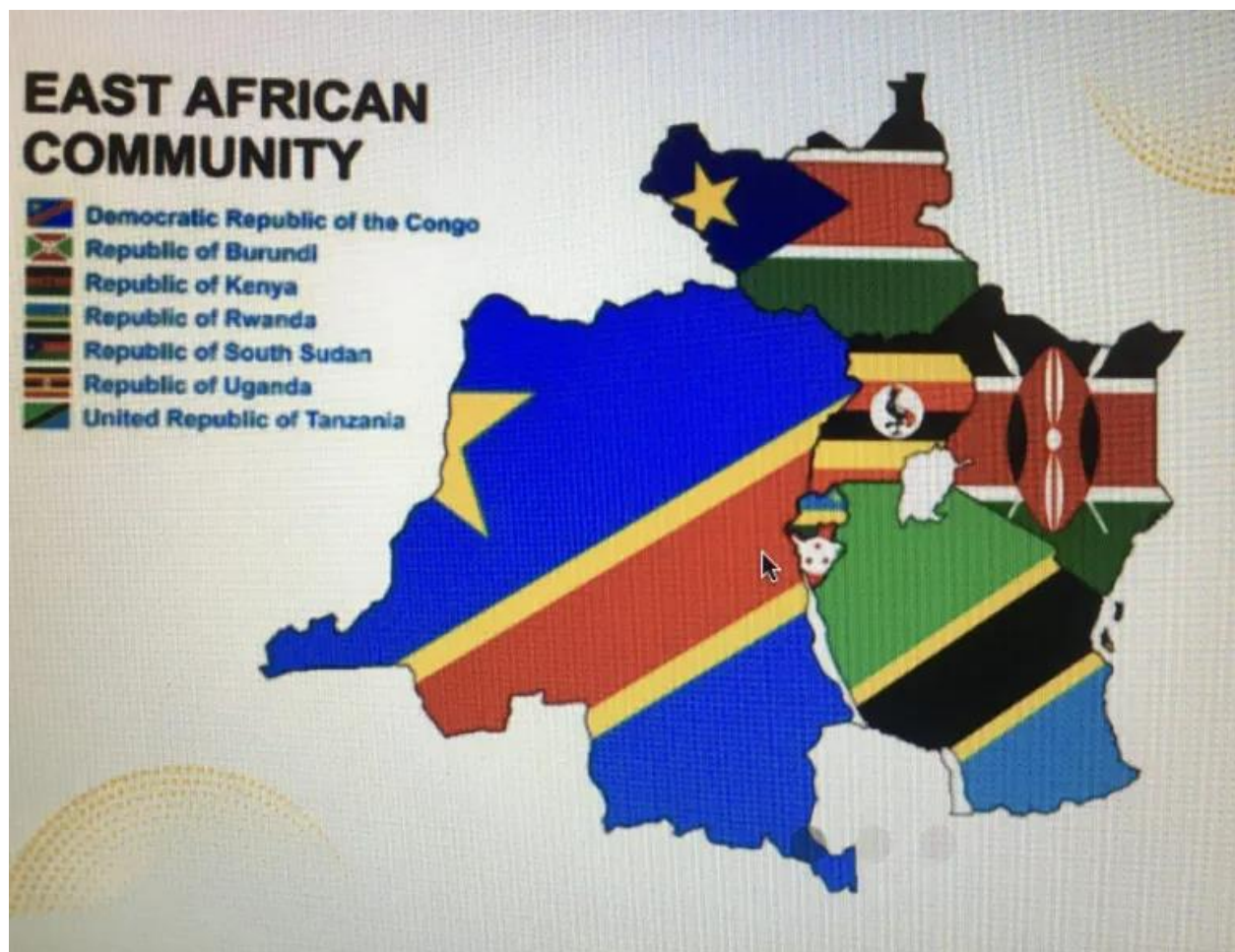
Some of the lessons from South Africa system of education may include and not limited to:

- South African Schools Act of 1996 with the aim of promoting access, quality and democratic governance in schooling system and ensuring access to quality education without discrimination
- Implementation of Outcome Based Education (OBE) with aim of nurturing independent and critical thinking
- Compulsory General Education and Training (GET) Grade 1-9
- Curriculum focusing on global general trends like sciences, technology and innovation
- Division of Universities into traditional, technology and comprehensive
- Technology Universities being more profession with focus on vocational courses
- Creation of non-fee paying public schools especially for poorest areas and generally subsidizing fees
- Heavy investment in Universities making Universities accessible to the poorer students and improvement of quality making them competitive globally
- National Students Financial Aid that distributes loans and bursaries
- Tax breaks encouraging Public Private Partnerships (PPP) in research activities
- Professionalization of teaching
- Continuing education and training Act of 2006

### Education in East Africa Community

#### Introduction

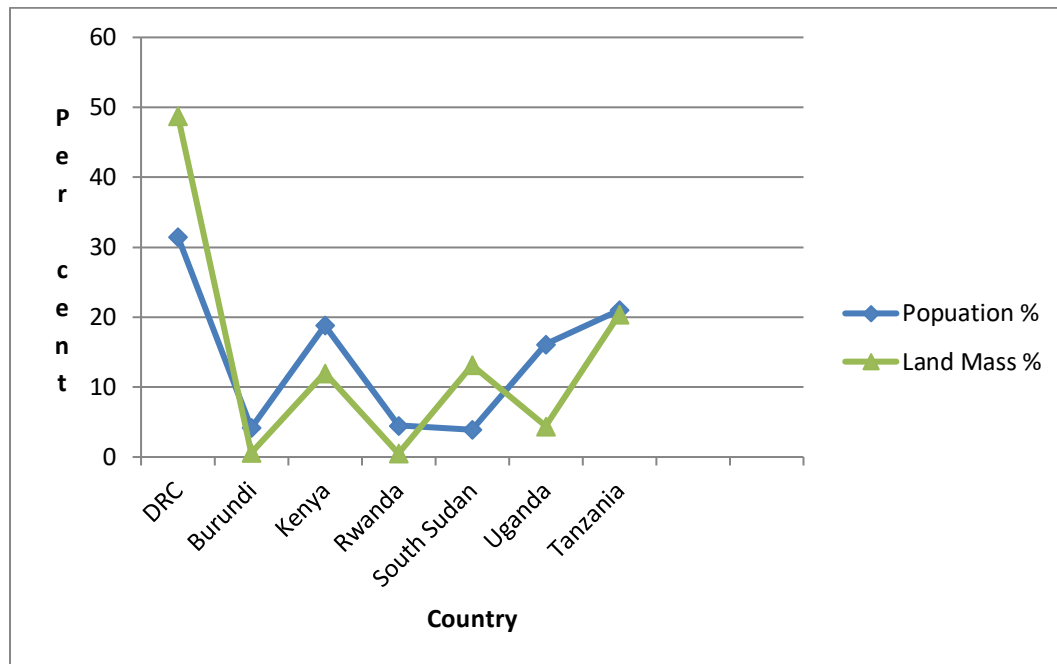
The East Africa Community (EAC) is a regional intergovernmental organization of seven partner states; Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC), Republic of Burundi, Republic of Kenya, Republic of Rwanda, Republic of South Sudan, Republic of Uganda and United Republic of Tanzania (URT). The community is situated on the eastern part of African continent and great lakes region, but with admission of DRC, it now extends from Indian Ocean to the Atlantic Ocean. It was first established in 1967 by Kenya, Uganda and Tanzania but later disintegrated due to political and ideological differences. However, it was re-established in the 2000. By 2021, it was a home of about 292.91 million citizens occupying land area of 4.64 Million square kilometers. The official languages are English and Kiswahili. Figure 1 below shows the map of the region



#### Determinants/factors influencing education in the system in the region

#### Geographical

The population and land mass distribution in the region is shown in the Figure 9 below shows 2021 population and land mass distribution in the region



From figure 9 above, Burundi, Kenya, Rwanda and Uganda are densely populated. Tanzania is evenly distributed while South Sudan and DRC are sparsely populated. Table 1 below shows the structure of education and languages spoken in each country

| Country            | Structure       | Languages                                   | Colony of |
|--------------------|-----------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>DRC</b>         | 2-6-6-3         | Swahili, French, Lingala, Kikongo, Tshiluba | Belgium   |
| <b>Burundi</b>     | 2-6-4-3-3       | Kirundi, French                             | Belgium   |
| <b>Kenya</b>       | 8-4-4/2-6-3-3-3 | Kiswahili, English,                         | Britain   |
| <b>Rwanda</b>      | 6-3-3-4         | Kinyarwanda, English, Kiswahili, French     | Belgium   |
| <b>South Sudan</b> | 8-4-4           | English, Indigenous languages, Arabic       | Britain   |
| <b>Uganda</b>      | 7-4-2-3         | Luganda, English                            | Britain   |
| <b>Tanzania</b>    | 2-7-4-2-3       | Kiswahili, English, Arabic                  | England   |

- Table 1 above shows that South Sudan has 8 years of primary schooling; Uganda and Tanzania have 7 years while the rest have six years.
- All countries have a two tier secondary education apart from South Sudan and Kenya which is transitioning
- Rwanda and south Sudan have 4 years of university education while the rest have three years
- With regard to language, no single language is common in all the member states
- The most daunting task that the EAC education Council faces is to create a uniform curriculum for education since they present an incompatible marriage of sorts to the harmonization team.

### **Historical and political factors impacting on education**

#### **South Sudan**

- Sudan was colonized by Britain 1899-1956 and the colonial rule created a rift between Muslim and Arabic speaking north from the multi-religious, multi-ethnic and multilingual south by favouring the north.
- After independence, the mistrust between the north and the south culminated into a large scale armed conflict in the mid-1950s
- There was a civil war between 1955-1972 and 1983-2005. This wars were led by Dr. John Garang de Mabior as the commander of Sudan People's Liberation Army (SPLA) from the majority Dinka clan, Dr. Riek Machar from second largest Nuer clan and Carabino Kyuany Bol
- Political marginalization and economic neglect of the south by successive national governments sparked the civil wars
- In 2003, there was Darfur genocide where many people were killed and others over 300,000 took refuge in Chad and Libya.
- Comprehensive Peace Agreement (CPA) was signed in 2005 making Dr. Garang become the president of south Sudan and vice president of republic of Sudan.
- Dr. Garang died in a helicopter crash, shortly after signing CPA and his position was taken by his deputy then Salva Kiir Mayardit also a Dinka.
- 98% of South Sudan supported secession in a referendum and it became the 54<sup>th</sup> African state in 2011 where Kiir become the president and Dr. Machar the vice-president
- Abyie region remains disputed areas between south Sudan and Sudan
- 2013, Kiir fired the entire cabinet including the vice president Dr. Riek Machar leading to over 4 million people forced to flee their homes with 2 million being refugees in neighbouring countries, making it the largest refugee crisis in Africa
- The sacking and signing of peace agreements seems to be the trend as Dr. Riek Machar have been reappointed for the third time by 2022
- The question of conflict, refugee, hunger skyrocketing inflation have hampered education amidst an island of plenty in terms of vast arable land, production of oil

#### **Democratic republic of Congo (DRC)**

- DRC gained independence from Belgium in 1960. The country was known as Congo, and the first president was Joseph Kasavubu and Patrice Lumumba as the prime minister with capital city in Kinshasa
- Ideological differences between the president and prime minister lead the president dismissing the prime minister and prime minister on his part also dismissing the president, a scenario that created a parallel government in 1961.
- A military colonel Joseph Mobutu supported the president and consequently, Patrice Lumumba was executed.
- The president appointed another prime minister but the choice led to resistance causing paralysis in the government.
- Mobutu took advantage of the situation and sized power in a bloodless coup in 1965. He changed the name of the country to Zaire and attempted to Africanize the country including ordering use African names only.
- Throughout his tenure, he suppressed any divergent views in the country and remained a dictator

- In 1997, Mobutu was overthrown by Laurent Kabila with the help from Rwanda who were pursuing Rwanda rebels that had crossed to Kivu province of DRC
- Laurent Kabila changed the name of the country from Zaire to DRC. He was later assassinated by his bodyguard in 2001 and his son Joseph Kabila took over
- DRC had a disputed presidential election in 2018, nonetheless, Joseph Kabila is credited as the first president to hand over power at the end of his term in the country peacefully to Tshsekedi
- In summary, the history of DRC is replete with coups, wars, killing and displacement and foreign soldiers and this has had serious ramifications on education yet is a country that is well endowed with natural resources like copper, cobalt, manganese, diamond, gold, arable land, diverse biodiversity like second largest forest in the world, rivers lakes etc.

### **Republic of Burundi**

- Burundi which was in the Ruanda-Urundi kingdom was initially colonized by Germany and then Belgium following the League of Nations agreement.
- Ruanda-Urundi gained independence in 1962, and immediately split into independent Rwanda and Burundi.
- The politics of Burundi has been characterized by military coup d'état and assassinations and genocides
- In 1972, the country witnessed Burundi genocide where the majority Hutus caused atrocities against Tutsi civilians where 800-1200 people were killed. The Hutus were leaning towards communism as Tutsi minority dominated in the government positions
- 1993-2005, Burundi witnessed genocide and in summary, Burundi has had over 10 presidents, characterized by either being deposed or assassinated.
- Francois Ngeze for instance was in office for 6 days only while Sylvie Kiningi who self-declared president and prime minister at the same time was in office for 106 days.

All this has negatively impacted on access of education in the country

### **National Goals of education in Burundi**

- Ensuring Education for All
- Promoting human resources development
- Improving security and good governance
- Promoting equitable and lasting economic growth
- Promoting mental and physical health

## Education in the Republic of Rwanda

### Country profile

Rwanda is a country that is poetically referred to as “the Land of a Thousand Hills”. It’s a landlocked country located in east-central Africa. It borders Burundi, Uganda, Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) and Tanzania, covering an area of 26.33 square kilometres with a population of 13.28 million people in 2021 hence the most densely populated country in Africa. The country has few natural resources and the economy is based mostly on subsistence agriculture by the local farmers using simple tools. Coffee and tea are major crops for export while substance crops include bananas (Matooke) that occupies one third of the farmland, potatoes, beans, sweet potatoes, cassava, wheat and maize. The capital city is Kigali and Kinyarwanda is the official language of education during the first 3 years of primary education, after which all education is provided in English.

A map of Rwanda is shown in Figure 1 below.



### Historical and political factors impacting on education

- Just like Burundi, Rwanda was in Ruanda-Urundi kingdom that was colonized initially by Germany from 1884 to 1916 and then followed by Belgium from 1916 to independence in 1962.
- The colonial authorities radicalized the society into Hutu, Twa and Tutsi and ethicized access to and opportunities for formal education which served to reinforce ethnic divisions. Consequently, conflict characterized by military coup d'état, assassinations and genocides ensued after independence (Karareba *et al*, 2019).
- In 1980s, over 480,000 Rwandans were refugees in Burundi, Uganda, Zaire and Tanzania. In 1988, Rwandan Patriotic Front (RPF) founded in Kampala, Uganda as a political and military movement with the aim of securing repatriation of Rwandans in exile and reforming of Rwandan government including political power sharing. In 1994, Rwandans population stood at more than 7 Million people comprising three ethnic groups; Hutu 85% Tutsi 14% and Twa one per cent. But due to the genocide, 800, 000 to 1 Million Tutsi people were estimated to have perished while over 2 million Hutus had to seek refuge in Tanzania and Congo especially in Kivu province. Further, an estimated 150,000 to 250,000 women were raped. Another genocide followed in DRC where Tutsi extremists would massacre 235,000 Hutu refugees who had crossed the border.
- The genocide was a culmination of huge unemployment among the Hutus who wanted to drive Tutsis from the country as they were considered foreign and therefore minority and many had already lost education pre 1994 genocide.
- Post 1994 genocide period was harsh and chaotic where roughly 10% of the population had died due to the genocide, 2 million refugees displaced, and country's infrastructure destroyed or heavily damaged, economy destroyed and social trust evaporated (Nkurunziza *et al*, 2012). Schooling came to a complete stop in April 1994 and reopened again in September 1994 when approximately 75% of primary and secondary teachers had been killed, fled or were in prison (Taka, 2021).
- Schools had to be built or rebuilt since out of 1836 country's schools, only 648 were operational. Furthermore, Rwanda was one of the country with the world's highest rates of orphan hood, a situation compounded with HIV/AIDS prevalence. Moreover, there was need to convince the population that schools were safe places again given that a large number of public schools are linked to roman catholic church and during the massacres, people had believed that schools and churches were safe havens, but mass killings had occurred in those places ( Nkurunziza *et al*, 2012; Guariso & Verpoorten, 2019).
- Stigma attached to studying for primary when "old "and mocking, provision of accreditation of certificates from previous education like Uganda to restart education at an appropriate level, and introduction of English language as the only medium of instruction for grade 4 and above yet previously the medium of instruction was French compounded the challenges ( Taka, 2021).
- Nonetheless, President Paul Kagame, with his attention to detail reversed corruption and appreciation of markets marking the turning point for Rwanda and despite the post genocide harsh and chaotic realities, Rwanda has demonstrated a clear strategy to improve the education. Tangible strategies includes, change of objectives with the purpose of correcting errors made by pre-genocide political regimes, abolishing discriminatory policies and school fees, implementation of curriculum changes, banning of identification of teachers and students as Hutu or Tutsi and introduction of English in school systems in order to cater for the language needs of English speaking returnees,

catch-up programmes and private candidate programme (Karareba *et al*, 2019; Taka, 2021).

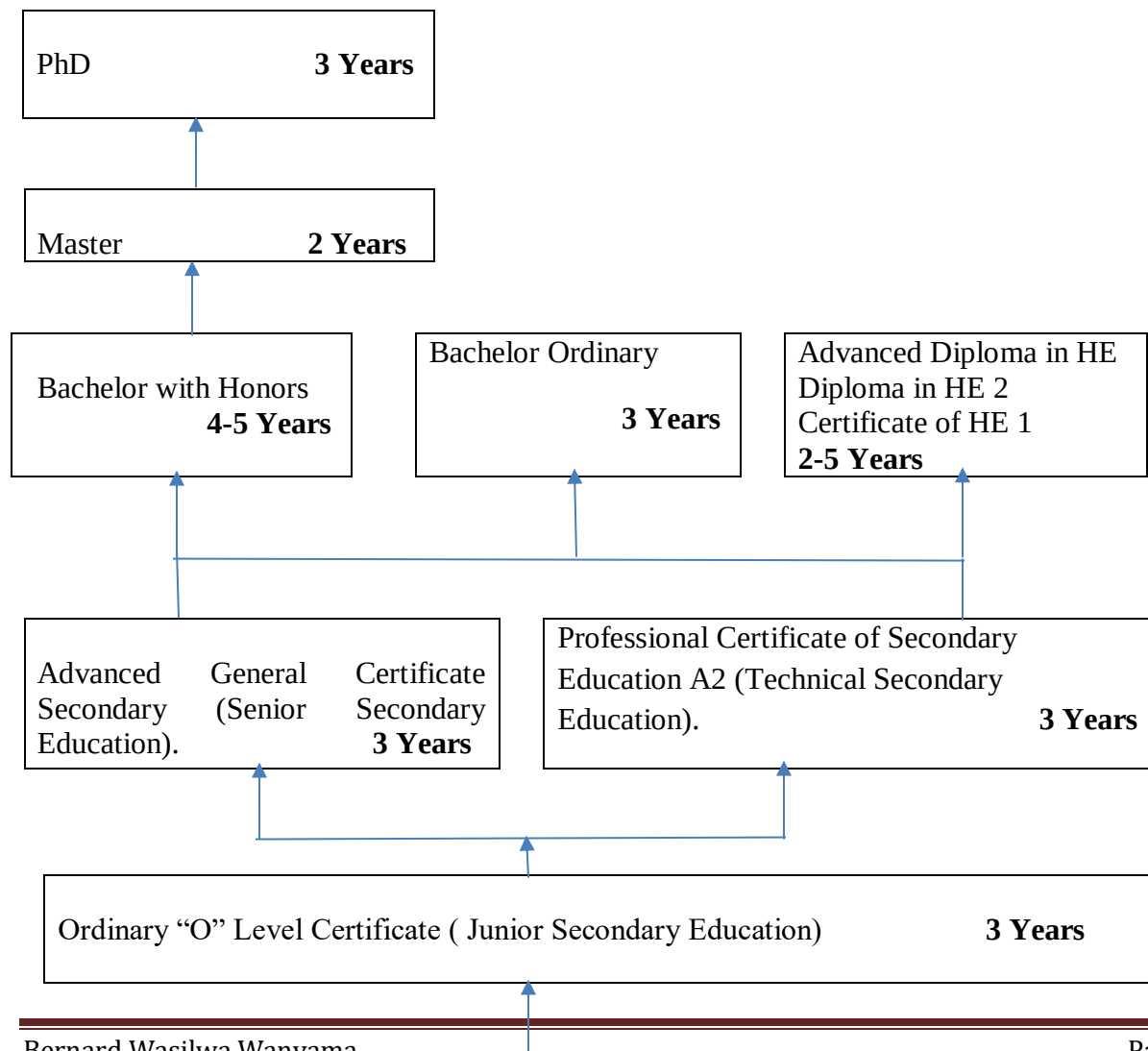
### National goals of education

1. Rwandans viewed as the major resource of the country.
2. Education is considered as a human right to be provided to all.
3. Education to be considered as a tool for molding the desired Rwanda citizen characterized by unity, work well done and patriotism as expressed in Rwanda's Motto (Ubumwe (Unity), Umurimo (work) Gukunda igihugu (patriotism)).
4. Cultural knowledge, skills and attitudes needed for development of all aspects of life.
5. Eradicating illiteracy and building a self –sustaining economy.

### Structure of education

The system is structured into four levels; 6-3-3-4

- I. Primary School- 6 years
- II. Junior Secondary School ( Ordinary level)- 3 years
- III. Senior Secondary School ( Advanced level)- 3 years
- IV. University Bachelor's level- 4 years



Primary Leaving Certificate ( Primary Education)

6 Years

### Primary level

- There are public, private and government aided private schools
- Children join at the age of 7 years and it last for 6 years and its compulsory education.
- At the end of primary, learners sits for national examination Primary Leaving Certificate which provides access to lower secondary.
- Offer two languages; Kinyarwanda in primary school P1-P3 and English from P4 through University
- Kiswahili and French taught as elective /supplemental while some private schools have both Francophone and Anglophone systems.

### Junior Secondary School

- Junior secondary marks the end of 9 years of compulsory basic education (9YBE)
- English, Kinyarwanda, Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, Biology, ICT, History, Geography, Entrepreneurship, French, Kiswahili, PE. Electives are Artistic, Home sciences, Agriculture
- Examinations at end of JSS in 9 subjects

### Senior Secondary School

- There are two pathways at SSS, general education and technical secondary education.
- General secondary takes examination in at least 3 predetermined subjects from their chosen specialization, general paper and entrepreneurship. They are awarded advanced General Certificate of secondary Education
- Technical education also lasts for 3 years where students selects general subjects and subjects focusing on specific area of specialization. They are awarded a professional certificate of secondary education
- There are 3 streams / academic tracks
  - I. Science
  - II. Humanities
  - III. Languages
- Take English through not examined
- Take examination in 3 subjects plus entrepreneurship and general paper

### Higher Education

- Provided in public and private Universities which falls under the jurisdiction of Ministry of Education.
- Advanced General Certificate of Secondary Education and Professional Certificate of Secondary Education grant access to higher education.
- There are five institutions of higher education; University of Rwanda, Integrated Polytechnic Regional Centers, Institute of Legal Practice and Development( ILPD), Nursing Schools and Private Higher Learning Institutions.
- University of Rwanda (UR) was established in 2013 as a result of a merger between Rwandan public Universities and former Universities become colleges of the University of Rwanda and they are:
  - (i) College of Arts and Humanities
  - (ii) College of Business and Economics

- (iii) College of Science and Technology
- (iv) College of Education
- (v) College of Medicine and Health Sciences
- (vi) College of Agriculture, Animal Sciences and Veterinary Medicine
  - The UR absorbed Kigali Institute of Science and Technology (KIST), Kigali Institute of Education (KIE), Institute of Agriculture and Animal Husbandry (ISAE), School of Finance and Banking (FB) and Higher Institute of Umutara Polytechnic (UP) & Kigali Health Institute (KHI)
  - Public polytechnics offers 3 years Higher National Diplomas in Education, Technology, Human health, Animal health and Nursing.

### **Administration**

- Administration of education is centralized where it's overseen by the Ministry of Education.
- The ministry sets overall policies, develop school curriculum, examination in school system and standards for teacher training.
- The initial 12 provinces were merged in 2006 to introduce five provinces (Northern, Eastern, Western, Southern and Kigali City).
- The provinces are further divided 30 Districts (Akarere), 416 Sectors (Imerenge), 2,148 Cells (Ufugari) and 14,842 Villages (Imudungu) (JICA, 2012).
- Education is locally administered by District Education Officers (DEO)
- Higher education is administered by central government by Ministry of Higher Education Council (HEC) which operates as an independent government agency.
- It's responsible for the structure, organization and performance of all higher education institutions by monitoring and evaluation through vetting and recognition, accreditation of programs, quality and standards.
- Rwandan Qualifications Framework outlines requirements for the awarding of degrees by higher education institutions and it's based on the Credit Accumulation and Modular Scheme (CAMS).

### **Funding**

- In 2003, constitution made education at the primary level free and mandatory for all children and improved funding education budget to about 25.6% of total spending.
- Free education to grade 12, although free education isn't truly free since parents pay for items like PTA contributions, mock examinations fee, purchasing reams of papers, passport photos, registration fees school reports etcetera.

### **Reforms**

- In 2003, constitution made education at the primary level free and mandatory for all children and improved funding education budget to about 25.6% of total spending and this increased enrolment to 98% (Nkurunziza et al, 2012).
- The Rwanda vision 2020 articulated the need to transform the country from an agriculture-based to a knowledge-based economy. This was to be achieved through provision of high quality science and technology education and development of ICT skills (Government of Rwanda, 2012).
- In 2016, Rwanda implemented a skill based educational Programme (CBC) with the aim of building a knowledge-based economy, with particular emphasis on science and technology as an engine of social-economic development.

- Critical thinking, creative and innovative, interpersonal life skills, research and problem solving, communication and cooperation competencies were considered critical to Rwandese.
- Learners were to be engaged in active learning and helped to apply what they had learnt in real-life situations.
- Pupils were expected to apply digital literacy skills for learning and enjoyment hence teachers to integrate digital literacy across all subjects (Yumiko *et al*, 2017; Rwigema & Andala (2022).
- Initiatives launched to promote digitalization in basic education included; One Laptop Per Child (OLPC) in 2008, the Smart Classrooms initiatives introduced in 2016 and digital content development and integration of digital technology, strengthened since 2018 and building the capacity of teachers and education workers through training of level 4-6 teachers in ICT basic skills as part of science and elementary technology and One Laptop Per Teacher Initiative. Other initiatives involved repair and maintenance of laptops, Rwanda Digital Ambassadors Programme (DAP) where young Rwandans are trained as Digital Ambassadors to deliver basic digital skills training to the general population, particularly in rural areas and establishing the first coding academy in Rwanda in 2019 which is a specialised secondary school that supports high achieving students to develop coding skills necessary to prepare Rwandan youth into future software developers and cyber securing systems experts. In all this, the Ministry of Education has partnered with World Economic Forum (WEF), Digital opportunity Trust (DOT), Andela, a company training software developers which established a Pan-African tech hub in Rwanda and Korea International Cooperation Agency (KOICA) (JICA, 2020; APET, 2021; Ndayambaje, 2023).
- Rwanda's Ministry of Education has partnered with technology-enabled companies such as Microsoft, O' Genius Panada, Zora Robotics and class VR and the Keza Company among others, towards in cooperating STEM and ICT- enabled education system. The programmes developed allows for utilization of ICT and other technologies to promote transferable skills such as critical thinking, problem-solving, and creativity (APET, 2021).
- The system has been designed in a way that allows for extended time allocation for STEM-related subjects relative to arts-related subjects and is predominantly implemented at the primary school level. Additionally, significant investment in essential stem-related infrastructure such as laboratory equipment and accompanying materials necessary for teaching STEM subjects albeit more work to be done.
- Capacity Building Frameworks addresses the barriers hindering the STEM uptake through training teachers on teaching pedagogy which focuses lesson delivery that links classroom learning with the local environment, update curricula to localise their STEM education and makes it more practical to accommodate efficient methodologies of teaching science in schools and capacity in school leadership management improvement, planning, coaching and mentoring (APET, 2021).
- Students starting a higher education programme have the option of obtaining a diploma at the end of each year and the diploma awarded upon completion serves as a confirmation that the student has obtained the required number of credits.

- University of Rwanda (UR) joined Australia Africa Universities Network (AAUN), a network of leading Universities in Australia and Africa connecting researchers and academics under institutional partnership (Kagina, 2023).
- To respond to the challenge of delivering tertiary education to students from the most vulnerable background, Kepler in partnership with Southern New Hampshire University (SNHU) was launched in 2013. Kepler operates on academic model which combines in-person, on-line and on-the-job learning to prepare students for the workplace where intensive in-person series of classes to help enhance students' skills in communication, technology, critical thinking and professional competencies are delivered. More than 700 students enrolled in its flagship campus in Kigali and in 2015 a second campus was opened in Kiziba refugee camp, western Rwanda, which primarily serves Congolese refugee students. Students earn a US-accredited degree while studying in Rwanda (Teppo & Zolla, 2018).

### Challenges

- Despite appreciation of the new curriculum, there were challenges like;
  - (i) Lack of teaching and learning materials, laboratory equipment and chemical reagents.
  - (ii) Further, a small number of teachers got a training about the implementation of the new curriculum as they found implementation to be more time consuming, hence could not cover the content at the end of the academic year (Nsengimana, 2021).
  - (iii) Free education policy do not cover the cost of essential non-fee expenses such as textbooks, school uniforms, meals and transport. Consequently, "free" can therefore be unaffordable for low-income households, hence the benefits of fee abolition would mainly accrue to children from relatively privileged households and not help those who needed it most. Moreover, considering the precarious position of many African states, providing free secondary schooling to the entire population is likely to be fiscally unsustainable and instead divert scarce resources away from basic education which is already chronically underfunded (Gruijters, 2023).
  - (iv) Limited use of English in daily life leading to few competent teachers of English and lack of competent-based teaching aids and materials which reflected Rwandan context ( Dushimumuremyi, 2018)
  - (v) With regard to digitalization, differences in income, literacy and exposure levels among different households created a gap. Again, many schools still lacked access to ICT equipment and infrastructure as teachers lacked digital and ICT skills, while others were simply reluctant to embrace ICT in teaching and learning. Lack of school community readiness where users found the system too demanding and far beyond their competencies amplified resistance to the adoption (REB, 2019).

### **Republic of Uganda**

- Uganda was under British empire 1984-1962 and the country gained independence in 1962 with Dr. Milton Obote becoming prime minister and Kabaka Mutesa as the president
- Obote suspended the constitution in 1966 and declared himself the president of Uganda
- In 1971, Idi Amini Dada led a military coup and overthrow Obote forcing him to flee to the exile
- Amini presided over massive human rights violations, social disintegration and economic decline. For instance, in 1972, he ordered 40,000 Indians entrepreneurs to leave the country.
- Amini was overthrown in 1979 by assistance from Tanzania and he fled the country to Libya.
- Yusuf Lule took over in April 1979 and only to be overthrown in June the same year by Godfrey Binaisa.
- In May 1980, a military commission took over under the leadership of Paulo Mawanga. Elections were conducted in December 1980 where Milton Obote won and became the president for the second time.
- In July 1985, Obote was overthrown again by Tito Okello and he had to flee the country to Zambia.
- In 1986, Yoweri Museveni led guerrilla movement of National Resistance Army (NRA), and with the help of Paul Kagame, took over the country and he has remained at helm to date 2022.

Museveni has continued his authoritarian rule, amidst complains of massive violation of human rights, lack of pluralism and continued to perpetuate himself by changing the constitution to lift the presidential term limit, appointing his son as the General Commander of the defence forces and his wife as a minister in his government.

### **Goals of education in Uganda**

- Forging national unity and harmony
- Evolving democratic institutions and practices in society
- Guaranteeing fundamental human rights
- Creating national wealth
- Upholding and maintenance of national independence and patriotic feelings
- Promoting moral and ethical values
- Promoting a feeling of humanitarianism and cooperation
- 

### **United Republic of Tanzania**

- Tanzania is a union of Tanganyika main land and the archipelago of Zanzibar formed in 1964
- Tanganyika was colonized by Germany first followed by Britain and gained independence in 1961 while Zanzibar was a trading hub under Portuguese of Oman and the British empire
- The first independent president of Tanganyika was Mwalimu Julius Nyerere and Zanzibar was Abed Karume

- The two formed Chama Cha Mapinduzi (CCM) which has held power since independence and is the longest serving political party in Africa.
- Nyerere introduced African socialism/ Ujamaa, however, massive corruption engulfed the country forcing Nyerere to resign as the president in 1985 although he continued as the chair of CCM
- Notably, there has been smooth transition of power in Tanzania despite cases of suppressing divergent views, crack down on opposition political parties and general feeling of Zanzibar being marginalised.
- All this differences are related on the history of each country especially with regard to colonization.
- In Tanzania for instance, the education philosophy is derived from Mwalimu Julius Nyerere's Education for Self- Reliance (ESR), meaning delivering knowledge about 'self-reliance'.
- According to Nyerere, the policy of self-reliance meant that Tanzanian's development should depend on her natural resources.
- The concept of Education for Self Reliance is also about self-confidence, independence, responsibility and democratic involvement.
- According to Nyerere's viewpoint ESR, is a practical oriented education meant to provide real solutions to the societal needs.
- This kind of education is about work by everyone and exploitation by none-sharing of the resources which are produced by fellow humans.
- ESR- must set people free in order to encourage the citizens to rely upon their own developments and realize their full potentials.
- The educated individuals should serve the masses; they must also realize and recognize themselves as being part of the society.
- Therefore, an educated individual should be; relevant to the society, serve the society, integrated with society, problem solving and work oriented

### **National goals of education in Tanzania**

- Guide and promote the development and improvement of the personalities of the citizens of Tanzania, their human resources and effective utilization of their economic resources in bringing about individual and national development.
- Promote the acquisition of appropriate use of literacy, social, scientific, vocational, technological, professional and other forms of knowledge, skills and understanding for the development and improvement of man and society.
- Promote the acquisition and appreciation of culture, customs and traditions of the citizens of Tanzania
- Develop and promote self-confidence and an inquiry mind, an understanding and respect for human dignity and human rights and a readiness to work hard for personal self-advancement and national improvement
- Enable and expand the scope of acquisition, improvement and upgrading of mental, practical production and other life skills needed to meet the changing needs of industry and the economy
- Enable every citizen to understand the fundamentals of the national constitution as well as the enshrined human and civil rights, obligations and responsibilities
- Promote the working commitment of employees and to enhance production efficiency in goods and services

- Inculcate principles of national ethics and integrity, national and international cooperation, peace and justice through the study, understanding and adherence to the provisions of the national constitution and international charters
- Enable a rational use, management and conservation of the environment

### **Education structure**

- Structure of education: 2 - 7 - 4 - 2 - 3: years allocated to pre-primary, primary, ordinary secondary, advanced secondary and higher education.

### **Pre-primary**

- Mainly provided by private agencies, 2 years
- Provided in child care centers, nursery schools, Montessori/other preschools and pre-primary classes affiliated to primary schools.
- Provide education and care for children below five years.
- Largely regarded as a preparation for primary education and the curriculum focuses on the development of literacy and numeracy skills while social and emotional skills tend to be neglected

### **Primary Education**

- Students begin standard one at age 7 and start learning English in standard 3.
- In 1972 all primary school fees were abolished.
- In Jan 2002 FPE was re-introduced
- Kiswahili is a medium of instruction & also taught as a subject
- English is taught from grade 3 onwards
- Standard I-II: main goal is to develop competencies in the 3Rs. In these years, the curriculum focuses on developing competencies in Reading, Writing and Arithmetic's (the 3Rs) among pupils.
- This section is prepared considering that the early years of learning are very crucial for mental, physical & social development of a child.
- For Standards III –VII: Kiswahili, English, Mathematics, Civic and Moral Education, Science and Technology, Social Studies, Vocational Skills and optional subjects (French and Arabic). Nonetheless, at this stage, competencies in the 3Rs will still be emphasized in all subjects.
- Education for production is a fundamental part of the school curriculum
- At the end pupils sit for the primary school leaving certificate. Passing standard 7 determines the type of secondary school to join

### **Secondary education**

- Taught in English and this level is also divided into 2
- Lower secondary, O-Level 4 years which culminates in the certificate of secondary education and Upper secondary forms 5 and 6- Advanced level certificate of secondary education
- Admission to A- Level is a good pass at form four
- Political education is compulsory
- A level gives admission to university
- Students who fail form 4 or form 6 exams may go into an Advanced Vocational School and can train to be a head primary School teacher among other things

### **Higher Education**

- Mainly provided by universities
- Offer both undergraduate and post graduate courses
- Many of them face high unemployment or joblessness
- Serious difficulties in getting a firm foothold into the labor market.
- Many leave school without the requisite skills or competences needed in today's economy and society.

### **Administration**

- The Ministry of Education, Science, Technology and Vocational Training is responsible for the provision of education, supervision, vocational training and policy on science and technology

### **Financing**

- Free education in public primary and secondary schools so that no one is left uneducated.
- Government assign students to public universities and loan them upwards of 75% of the tuition fee especially those who scored division one
- This is stipulated in Tanzania's Development Vision 2025 and the National Strategy for Growth and Reduction of Poverty (NSGRP)

### **Teacher Education**

Primary teacher education is based on form four qualifications

- This takes 2 years in TTCs. These teachers are graded as follows:
- Grade A- Qualifies to teach all subjects in primary
- Grade B is obtained on promotion or by successfully completing 4 year course at a TTC
- Grade C teachers possess certificates and are qualified to teach the first two grades of primary education

Secondary school teachers are of two categories: Those who hold diplomas and are trained at the national college of education for 2 years after obtaining ASCE.

- Entitles them to teach lower secondary school
- Teachers for upper secondary-must have either a B.Ed. or PGDE & are trained at universities

### **Challenges:**

- On the whole problems facing education development in the region are cross-cutting and they include;
- Low investment, low capacity but high demand system like south Sudan is one of the country with lowest public expenditure on education
- Free education policy do not cover the cost of essential non-fee expenses such as textbooks, school uniforms, meals, PTA contributions, mock exams, fee, purchasing of reams of papers, passport photos, school supplies and transport. Consequently, "free" can therefore be unaffordable for low-income households, hence the benefits of fee abolition would mainly accrue to children from relatively privileged households and not help those who needed it most. Moreover, considering the precarious position of many African states, providing free secondary schooling to the entire population is likely to be fiscally unsustainable and instead divert scarce resources away from basic education which is already chronically underfunded (Gruijters, 2023).
- The long distance to school for many students, many responsibilities at home, poor health and funding, prevent many children from attending primary school.
- Lack of competent/quality teachers, shortage of learning materials, large student-to-teacher ratios, retaining teachers especially in rural areas, lack of in-service of teachers.

- Acute shortage of infrastructure to match with modern technology
- Low retention rates due to abject poverty, corrupt governance, wanton violence which is endemic (Katharine, 2016).
- Girls experiencing early pregnancies and marriages and school related gender-based violence and truancy among boys (USAID, 2022)
- Ethnic and racial tensions, conflicts and cultural pressures
- Among lowest literacy levels in the world, the case of South Sudan
- Inappropriate curriculum with less technical skills and overemphasis placed on University education and not enough on obtaining life-long practical skills (Katharine, 2016).

### **Education system in Kenya**

#### **How education reforms lead to the disadvantage of marginalized communities in Kenya**

It should be noted that in the implementation of CBC, marginalized communities have further been marginalized in Kenya. The candidate can highlight and not limited to the following points.

- a) Digital literacy and contemporary issues are integrated across all learning areas as ICT serves as a learning tool. This amplified marginalization of communities in Kenya since most parts of the country are not connected to the national grid. Poor internet connecting have severely affected reforms
- b) By the time of roll out, very few teachers had been trained and many who had undergone the training seemed to claim that they still did not know how to implement the CBC. This affected marginalized communities since they experience lack of trained teachers, leave alone those trained on CBC.
- c) CBC generally requires small classes for teachers to give personal attention to each learner. However, acute shortage of teachers especially in marginalized communities posed a major challenge in successful implementation of the new curriculum.
- d) Teacher training sessions were largely ineffective due to; overload of the training sessions which were on the whole quite inadequate, incompetent trainers/facilitators who had not properly conceptualized and understood the CBC, lesson plan and scheme of work were too lengthy which entailed too much preparation and paperwork and took more time at the expense of teaching time, lack of adequate training materials and inadequate information on the new curriculum, and Teachers Service Commission (TSC) transfer of the only CBC trained teachers in a school to other school leaving the school with none or less trained teachers. Such challenge become more pronounced among marginalized communities
- e) Inadequate infrastructure where the government have done minimum investment in marginalized areas. There is lack of permanent classrooms, desks and chairs for teachers and learners. For lower classes, teaching and learning is done under tree/shade in some schools. No braille materials.
- f) Serious problem with distribution and delivery of text books, learning print and digital materials. This had been delayed with schools starting implementation without necessary textbooks. This problem was further compounded by the fact that text books were not available in the market or bookshops. Examples of textbooks that were lacking included; Teachers hand book on the CBC implementation, approved pupils course books e.g.

Literacy activities books, Kenya sign language books, approved hygiene and nutrition activities books, play materials and creative activities books. Such challenges are more amplified among marginalized communities

- g) General lack of learning resources for learners with special needs hence diversity of learners with special needs was not catered for.
- h) Lack of stakeholder's involvement and general lack of exposure due to kind of life experienced by marginalized groups have further made the curriculum very unfamiliar. Parental and community involvement in the learning process can improve students' behaviour and participation in classroom.
- i) Any other relevant point

### **GLOBALIZATION AND EDUCATION**

Knight (2008) sees it as a process that increase the flow of people, ideas, culture, values, knowledge, technology and economy across borders resulting into a more interconnected and interdependent world.

Globalization is a process which regional economies, societies and cultures have become integrated through a global network of communication, transportation and trade. It also refers to economic integration or integration of national economies to international economies through trade, capital flows, migration, spread of technology and foreign investment.

Globalization is often synonymous with internationalization referring to the growing interconnectedness and interdependences of people and institutions throughout the world. Globalization denotes the complexities of interconnectedness and worldwide influence on local settings and responses to these influences.

It is driven by combination of factors i.e. social cultural, political, biological, technological.

#### **8.1. General effects of globalization**

- (i) Emergency of worldwide production markets and broader access to foreign products
- (ii) Emergency of better access to financial sources for borrowers i.e. world bank
- (iii) Realization of the global common market based on freedom of exchange goods and capital between markets. Interconnectivity of markets may cause the fall of countries market.
- (iv) Health becomes a commodity with structural adjustment programs, healthy systems are privatized and subsidized
- (v) Politics where there is creation of a world government that regulates relationships among governments
- (vi) Information- increased information flow between geographically remote locations i.e. fiber optic cables.
- (vii) The most popular language of the world i.e. Mandarin-Chinese spoken by over 845million, Spanish over 329million, English 328million, English is lingua franca of globalization i.e. 40% radio, traffic use English.
- (viii) Competition where each company has to compete for the new global markets.

- (ix) Advent of global environmental challenges which can be solved by international cooperation e.g. climate change

### **Negative effects of globalization**

- (i) Led to lowering the quality of life in areas that are not ready to change.
- (ii) Led to increased inequality
- (iii) Environmental degradation
- (iv) Sweatshops- put industries in china where there is cheap labour (multinationals) not in Europe. They don't benefit much but investors get the profits
- (v) Cultural effect- influences from other cultures
- (vi) Flooding of consumer goods e.g. textile, radio, bicycles etc. leading to death of local companies
- (vii) Brain drain
- (viii) Food security
- (ix) Diseases- black disease from china to Europe, HIV AIDS spread from one country to others, Ebola
- (x) Illicit drugs
- (xi) Terrorism

### **8.2. Implications of globalization to education**

- In influences countries to carry out educational reforms to improve international competences, improve on quality, enhance their advantages, and adjust educational policies and systems to strengthen international cooperation.
- The national state that has been as the core of comparative education now unbundled leading to more similarities of education systems in given world regions.
- Mobility of students and labour- possibility of experiencing others systems
- Harmonization of national educational systems e.g. Europe
- Ease in attaining data for comparison
- Interactions/exchanges/collaborations between different countries
- Comparability/standardization and equation of national qualifications
- Education systems focus on training global citizens
- International dimensions/ comparative perspectives of curriculum
- It has enhanced the essence of comparative education.
- Use of ICT in the teaching and learning
- Some negative consequences such as brain drain, curriculum influences

### **BRAIN DRAIN**

Brain drain is the emigration of highly talented, skilled or intelligent people from particular country. This is loss of skilled intellectual and technical labour through the movement of such labour to more favorable geographical, economic or professional environment.

### **Causes of brain drain**

- (i) Lack of employment or low salaries and thus people are tempted to look for better salaries elsewhere. Unemployment and underemployment may force people out of their country.

- (ii) Political instability in home countries, thus they lose confidence to their governments and future prospects for a better life. These may be individuals who have differences because of their ethnic, cultural, regional or political persuasions. This is migration as a response to wars, politics and social turmoil.
- (iii) Unsatisfactory living conditions e.g. poor transport, housing, electricity, water etc. This may cause migration with a hope of finding better life elsewhere which satisfies ones needs.
- (iv) Many scholars who goes abroad for further studies or have gone for any other reason may remain their leaving behind their families and work place with a hope of better life.
- (v) Lack of information and guidance. They are tempted by significantly higher wages and better future prospects.
- (vi) Lack of research and other facilities including support staff, inadequate research funds, and lack of professional equipment's and tools.
- (vii) Under-utilization of qualified personnel, lack of satisfactory working conditions, low prospects of professional development.
- (viii) Discrimination in appointment and promotion, thus causing people to try opportunities elsewhere and those discriminated in promotion would want to be working where they are satisfied with who they are.
- (ix) Desire for higher qualifications and recognition. Some can move to countries because they need to be recognized to be working or prestige of foreign training.

### **Effects of brain drain**

- (i) One benefit of this aspect of the movement of skilled people is brain circulation. According to this concept, migration makes it possible for exchange of knowledge and ideas which is beneficial for everyone contributing.
- (ii) Developing countries may gain tax revenue sent back home. Equally, workers may gain experience and knowledge from working in other countries. This knowledge can then be used when they return.
- (iii) Expatriates are a vital source of income for many countries. In many cases, money sent home by expatriates contributes hugely to the GDP. Pakistan is leading this statistic with more than a third of its GDP coming from remittances.
- iv) If education is subsidized, the investment is lost as the highly educated person leaves a country and becomes an asset to other countries.
- v) Brain drain reduces number of dynamic and innovative people weather entrepreneurs or academicians. This increases dependence of foreign technical assistance and slows the transfer of technology and widens the gap between developing and industrialized countries.
- vi) It reduces the already low quantity of skilled manpower available in African countries which are developing and hence need them for development.
- vii) There is depletion of natural supply of intellectual talent benefiting the developed counties and individuals themselves. Statistics indicate that Africa suffers more from these unfortunate phenomena of intellectual migration.

### **Suggested solutions of curbing brain drain**

- Good governance at the national and international arena especially maintenance of reasonable security for people's lives and property is essential for economic progress. This will prevent political and economic emigrants who blame their government's failure for political unrest and stagnant economic growth. Transparency in leadership is essential and should be maintained.
- Offering higher wages for insiders according to their qualifications is essential instead of over estimating and hiring expatriates which are more costly.
- Education plays a powerful role especially in the growing problems of international migration. Therefore offering these individuals the necessary educational qualifications in their home countries and expanding a better educational infrastructure may definitely prevent emigrants who are seeking a higher education abroad.
- Seeking alternative measures for return of warrant from the beneficiaries such as withholding of academic degrees until graduates return and are willing to solve the people, may be another considerable alternative.
- Taxing emigrants who are indigenously trained in home countries. This indeed a sensitive issue and may sound absurd and may potentially infringe on the basic human right and freedom to choose the nature and location of individuals where to live and where to work. Thus, it must be agreed upon by international community and international laws.
- Since richer African states are also the shareholders of this brain drain, a deal must be made between rich and poor states of the continent that prohibits the later from taking intellectuals of the poorest states.

### **ACCESS AND EQUITY IN EDUCATION**

The idea of access and equal opportunity in education was first mounted in 19<sup>th</sup> century by Jean Jacques Rousseau and Thomas Jefferson. According to them, equal opportunity in education simply means equal chances to access to education and as well as equal chances to participating in the acquisition of education.

### **EFFORTS TO FACILITATE ACCESS AND EQUITY IN EDUCATION**

1. **Abolition of school fees** usually encourage access and equal opportunity because parents do not have to pay for education of their children e.g. with introduction of free primary education in Kenya 2003 the net enrolment rate rose.
2. **The school feeding programs-** where meals are provided to learners in order to meet their immediate food needs. It ensures that learners/ children have a balanced diet at least once a day and these guards against malnutrition. It is a very popular Program in England and Wales. In Kenya, it is practiced in the arid and semi-arid schools. UNICEF has been providing feeding to primary schools mostly in the slums.
3. **Compensating education Program-** this is a strategy intended for the children from deprived family background. The aim is to assist the individual groups of children that have no good chance as others. The strategy involves arranging for extra time to be spent coaching children in order to provide a form of compensation for what they have missed. It has been successful in the USA and South Africa.
4. **Comprehensive schools-** The model of a comprehensive school differs from country to country e.g. in Sweden, students are channeled into specialized areas as early as possible. In Britain, students are grouped based on their performance both in elective and

curriculum subjects. In England and Wales, comprehensive schools offer a range of courses to cater for all students. The main aim of a comprehensive school is to provide a wide choice to students so that each student finds where he/she fits best

5. **Re-current education-** an effort that aims at getting away from strict age consideration. In this approach, years in school may be extended in order to assimilate the required learning. In this case, individuals are allowed to finish their courses at varying times according to their efforts and ability. This also allows a break from work i.e. one takes a break goes to work and comes back to continue. However, it has not been tried in many countries because of the challenges of its implementation.
6. **Pedagogical differentiation-** classes are divided according to ability of learners in a given subject. In most cases, learners are divided into 2 main groups' i.e. High ability group and low ability group. The teacher then divides the time for attending to each of the groups. The main idea in this approach is to give each child a chance to learn at his/her own pace.
7. **Loaning/bursary system-** this is often done by governments, international organizations, faith based organizations or even individuals. In order to assist needy students. The main aim is to provide funds to students so that they can pay their education.
8. **Re-entry policy** where teenage mothers go back to school.
9. **Multi-grade teaching-** other terms are multi-level, class combination, split class teaching. In this approach, the teacher teaches more than one category of students in the same classroom. This approach mainly caters for limited number of pupils and teachers. Was piloted in Wajir sub-county in Kenya but has been very successful in Ethiopia, Colombia, Spain, Finland and Greece.
10. **Double shift system-** one group of learners uses the available learning resources at a given period of time while other learners use the same facilities at different times e.g. holiday and evening programs. The main aim is to cater for limited resources.
11. **Mobile schools-** these are schools that follow the pupils where they are located. They are common in the nomadic communities who keep moving from place to place in search for pastures. In most cases, teachers for the mobile schools are recruited from the nomadic/pastoralist families. The type of education provided is often basic i.e. reading, writing and basic arithmetic.
12. **Distance learning-** refers to learning that takes place outside the classroom situation where the learner and teacher do not necessarily come face to face. It can take any of the following:
  - ✓ Correspondence
  - ✓ Radio broadcasting
  - ✓ Tele-conferencing
  - ✓ E-learning
  - ✓ Recorded teaching/tape/mp3, CDS/DVDS/mass media

### TEACHER EDUCATION TODAY

Teacher education is a process of equipping the teacher with necessary skills and knowledge for performing teaching duties. It involves preparing the teacher to understand the learners and how to handle them. It enhances the performance of the teacher and the teacher is trained for his/her job especially in pedagogy.

### Who is a teacher?

- Is anyone involved in pedagogical matter in a classroom
- Is an instructor on what is to be done and how it should be done
- A mold of behavior to worn and direct thus showing the wrong and right and blowing the whistle in danger.
- Is a facilitator of knowledge so that those who he/she teaches change their way of thinking.
- Teacher imparts knowledge in a structured manner especially in lowers levels of learning.
- Teacher is one who shares knowledge with others through research.
- A teacher is one who develops knowledge and disseminates knowledge by publishing information to others.
- A teacher is a trainer who shows the way and is practically involved.

### Types of teacher education

Teacher education is that type of education given to those preparing to become teachers. In East Africa, teacher education is largely divided into two:

- i. Those training as pre-primary school teachers
- ii. Those training as primary school teachers
- iii. Those training as secondary school teachers/post-secondary teachers

The success of every education system depends on how well the teacher has been prepared.

### Models of training

1. **Concurrent model**- Student is admitted and does both teaching subjects content and methodology at the same time.
2. **Consecutive model**- Train in teaching subjects content e.g. Bachelor of Arts (BA) or Bachelor of Science (BSc) but later specialize in methodology through post graduate diploma in education.

### Objectives of teacher education

1. Develop the basic theoretical and practical knowledge about the teacher profession so that the teachers' attitude and abilities can be turned towards professional commitment and competence.
2. To develop in the teacher the ability to communicate effectively.
3. Bearing in mind the child as the center of education, teacher education should prepare teachers who can:
  - i. Provide a conducive learning environment
  - ii. Provide in the learner higher learning opportunities
  - iii. Develop the child's potentials and abilities to the maximum through a variety of learning experiences
  - iv. Develop the child's senses of citizenship and patriotism for his/her country.
  - v. Develop the child's communication skills.
  - vi. Develop awareness and acquisition of knowledge for other national and international communities.

- vii. Develops the child's ability in critical thinking and problem solving aspects of learning.
- viii. Develop positive attitude to the moral and religious values of his/her community.
- 4. To create a national consciousness for excellence in every teacher.
- 5. To create opportunities to develop special interests and skills and promote initiative on the part of the teacher e.g. improvisation.
- 6. To develop in the teacher the ability to adapt to change on new situations.
- 7. Develop awareness and appreciation of innovation in the fields of education and ability to utilize them e.g. e-learning.
- 8. Develop awareness of principles which underlies good human relationships and use these principles in their dealings with the children and community e.g. fairness.
- 9. Promote national unity, national development and social equality.
- 10. To develop in every teacher awareness and appreciation of the role of technology in national development
- 11. To develop in the teacher an awareness and appreciations of good health and environmental conservation.

➤ **Challenges Facing Teacher Education in Africa**

- The issue of Unemployment-This demotivates the teacher trainees hence the profession doesn't attract those with passion in teaching. They don't take the training seriously because to them teaching is just a stepping stone to other greener pastures. Such teachers can't execute their roles as teachers in future.
- Disillusionment: Learning to teach which is gained through training is only part of the process of teacher socialization. In order to effectively function, teachers have also to acquire the attitude, interest, knowledge and culture of the occupational group they belong to which is not offered in teacher training institutions
- Curriculum: Education is dynamic and requires regular updating as new knowledge emerge. The curriculum subjects sometimes do not match with what the job market requires. The mismatch between supply and leads to education wastage as such subjects would only lead to careers that are not marketable.
- Indiscipline cases. Majority of teachers are ill prepared in their training to handle indiscipline cases like students' strikes, burning of schools, drug and substance abuse etc.
- ICT integration. Most teacher training institutions teach ICT as a subject instead of using it to teach the subjects. It becomes a challenge therefore to apply the same in classroom situation or during a time like this when we outbreak of COVID 19 dictates blended teaching and learning.
- The training takes theoretical approach. Most and teaching/learning is highly academic and theoretical and this discourages critical thinking and problem solving approaches in life and this makes hard for the teacher to solve learners problems
- Short internship duration/teaching practice as compared to other professions like medicine, engineering etc. this affects the exposure/experience that the trainee requires with different social groups and by the time they graduate they are inadequately prepared to be effective teachers.
- Subject specialization. ECE and Primary school teacher training institutions train all the subjects because those teachers are supposed to teach all subjects after employment. This has adverse effects because it doesn't mean all teachers are good in

- all subjects. Teachers therefore end up messing learners in the subjects they aren't good in.
- Collaboration across networks leading to influence. Most teacher training institutions don't have such arrangements and this is a tragedy because in the event that a teacher isn't employed by the TSC, he/she tarmacs for a very long period. Collaboration would ensure teachers are employed in other sectors as instructors.
  - The issue of globalization. Globalization and education is not a well-recognized area in teacher education and training. The absence of this inhibits the competence of a teacher in making global citizens.

### TEACHING PROFESSION IN JAPAN

- i. Teacher training is administered by the **Central Government**.
- ii. One has to graduate from a **ministry approved university teacher education programme** and then get a teaching certificate for a particular school level.
- iii. There is **continuous professional development (in- service training)** on pedagogy and student guidance.
- iv. The **Japanese Society for Study of Education (JSSE)** is an example of an organization for professional research and study.
- v. **Teacher Training Curriculum** contains academic subjects, moral education and special activities.
- vi. **The teaching profession is highly respected.** "Sensei" (Teacher) means one who has seen before.
- vii. **Salaries are about 4% higher** than the average college educated civil servant.
- viii. **The annual salary is 3.5M Yen;** which increase every year to about 7M Yen at age 40. At retirement (age 60) it's about 9M Yen.
- ix. The handsome package and generous retirement benefits **motivates teachers** to perform well in their work.
- x. Japan has **robust Teachers' Unions** eg. Japan Teachers Union (JTU) and Japan Federation of Teachers (JFT).

### MINORITY GROUPS AND EDUCATION IN AFRICA- PROVIDING EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES

#### Who are minority groups?

- Marginalized and oppressed groups
- Those who are excluded from essential services
- Those who are unable to participate fully in educational, political and societal affairs relative to other people.

#### They include:

Orphans, HIV/AIDS affected and infected children, children caught up in turmoil and armed conflict, children of imprisoned mothers, the girl child due to poverty, culture, religion and other social reasons, child laborers, children of marginalized groups, children with disabilities, refugees, children living in slum areas, more recently the boy child, children with various illnesses including mental illness, bullying or peer victimization etc.

#### Who are more likely to be excluded from education and why?

#### Who are less likely to participate fully in education and why?

- Children from developing countries where most of Africa falls
- Those from poor households are less likely to be enrolled in or be able to attend to regularly attend school.
- Children from rural areas
- Children with disabilities
- Those living in areas affected by armed conflict.
- Children from ethnic and linguistic minorities face the burden of trying to learn the language of instruction
- Girls especially among poor households and in some religious communities.
- In many countries girls are less likely to attend school at higher levels than boys.
- Children in highly industrialized areas and technological advancement
- Children from different sexual orientation

#### What does it mean when children are excluded, or marginalized?

Marginalization leads to stigma, stereotyping, sidelining, exploitation, abuse, disadvantage, inequality, deprivation, discrimination and vulnerability.

- Disadvantaged groups struggle to gain access to resources and full participation in social life. In other words, marginalized children may be socially, economically, politically and legally ignored, excluded, or neglected, and, therefore vulnerable.
- Marginality demeans economic well-being, human dignity, and physical wellbeing and security.
- it deprives disadvantaged children of equal opportunity to participate in all activities for their full development like their advantaged counterparts
- it means that they lack access to important basic needs such as physical protection, food, health care, development of the child, equal protection and freedom from discrimination –

gender, national and regional origin, religion, disability, color, ethnicity, political affiliation, or other characteristics.

- they face a violation of their rights –right to free education, to special protection and care, right to association with both parents, human identity, to basic needs such as physical protection
- Marginalization at the individual level results in an individual's exclusion from meaningful participation in society.
- Eradicating exclusion means having children being physically, mentally and emotionally free from abuse and deprivation.
- it means providing equal opportunities to all children to participate equally in all aspects of their development

**What causes exclusion, marginalization? What hinders children from equal participation in education?**

Several factors hinder disadvantaged children from participating in equal terms with their peers from more advantaged groups. These include:

- Social deprivation or marginalization** -- Children in this category often lack the ability to enroll, participate, or be retained in schools because of their gender, cultural, religious, or other reasons. They are sidelined by society and have weak or no social networks or representation to champion for their rights. Social marginalization may take the form of
  - Gender Disparities: In Africa these are most salient in South Africa, Uganda, Malawi, Zimbabwe, Lesotho and Botswana. In many communities the girl child is vulnerable because she is not seen to be of economic value to the family since she will be married off -- investing in her education is not viable
  - Parental gender bias, cultural norms—the boy is the most valued child for family lineage – hence his education is a worthwhile investment
  - HIV/AIDS pandemic and poverty impacts adversely on the girl child's participation in education – takes care of sick and family.
  - drug use and abuse this largely affects the boy child – drop out
  - social and peer pressure such as radicalization, the Illuminati culture
  - social class order and discrimination such as the Indian caste system- a hereditary class system of the Hindu society, distinguished by relative degrees of ritual purity or pollution and of social status. According to the Hindus Brahmins are the most pure caste and the Sudra are the lowest. Below these there are the untouchables or the Dalit who are excluded from the caste system because they have an unclean soul and no social status. The type, quality form of education is therefore given according the caste they belong to.
  - Peer victimization ..... the experience among children of being a target of the aggressive behavior of other children, harassment or bullying— as physical, verbal, or psychological abuse of victims by other children
- Family/social/parental breakdown leading frustration etc who is likely to engage in peer victimization?

Forms of victimization:

Flaming—writing content to provoke fear, rage, humiliation, or other negative emotions.

Harassment—sending offensive, vulgar, or insulting messages.

Denigration—spreading or posting information negative and damaging information to damage one's reputation.

Impersonation— using someone else's identity to access an account etc with the intent to cause harm to another's reputation or well-being.

Outing and Trickery—coercing someone to disclosing private information or images and then sharing this information online or via text message without their consent to embarrass them

Exclusion—sending a hurtful messages to a target victim implying that they are disliked, different or should be ostracized by others.

Cyberstalking—repeatedly sending intimidating messages to a target victim or threatening to harm the safety of the victim or someone to whom they are close.

Causing physical harm, even lead to death

Cold war and silence

Social media abuse

What can be done?

Implement a national policy to govern incidences

May 2018 Computer and Cyber Crime Act Kenya,

Kenya Information and Communications Act Chapter 411A, of 1998 and revised in 2012

Unfortunately the legislation is extremely vague when it comes to defining some of the offences, leaving a great deal open to individual interpretation. That's particularly troubling when it comes to things like "fake publications", since the act could be misused to censor free expression in the online space. (<https://theconversation.com/kenyas-new-cybercrime-law-opens-the-door-to-privacy-violations-censorship-97271>)

Increase funding to support teachers and students technological correctness

Train staff on effective defense against criminals' activity and their tactics and how to reduce the risk of becoming a victim. Instruction on good security practice is essential for all end users – that's staff and students to spot dodgy websites, iffy emails and other common attack vectors.

protect your accounts, your privacy, and your devices as best you can

machines owned by learning institutions should be covered by advanced versions of anti-virus and anti-malware and probably a web filtering service, which takes out some illegal material.

Have a code of use and security policies. If people use your systems, they have to adhere to the rules, and ignorance is not an excuse.

Counselling, teach cohesion, enforce rules, friendly teachers. Peace corners and peace talks, clubs, team building activities,

Teach cohesion competencies in CBC

- ii. **Disability:** this causes exclusion, discrimination and violence- such as the plight of people living with albinism in Tanzania and flowing over to adjacent countries
  - poor societal attitude--seen as the less productive members of the society –not a viable investment – access, unsuitable curriculum inadequate equipment, and assistive tools affects participation and retention
  - There are an estimated 150 million children with disabilities in the world
  - Most of these children have no access to rehabilitative health care or support services, and many are unable to acquire a formal education
  - Many are often withdrawn from community life even if they are not actively shunned or maltreated and are left without adequate care – largely due to societal views on disability
  - They are viewed negatively by the society and thus the services given them are also second grade. This is also seen in the language used to describe them
  - Where special provision is made for CWDs it involves segregating them in institutions.
- iii. **Economic Marginalization** this is marginalization due to poverty. Children from poor households are often absent from schools to engage in income generating activities to supplement family incomes and carry out family chores. These include:
  - a. child labourers: hawkers,
    - girls-child prostitutes, domestic workers and drug peddlers, coffee and tea pickers
    - boys— manual workers and farm hands, loaders, mining, touting, Okada or boda boda Motor bike taxis in Nigeria, Kenya, Uganda, drug and contraband traffickers
  - b. children carrying out domestic chores – fetching water in dry areas, collecting relief food, firewood etc
  - c. providing security in conflict prone areas and ward off cattle rustlers such as Baringo, Pokot, Turkana and parts of Kitui in Kenya,
  - d. Poverty too leads to exclusion. In many of the world's cities, the poor live in slums. Some of the world's largest slums include:
    - Khayelitsha in Cape Town (South Africa): 400,000.
    - Kibera in Nairobi (Kenya): 700,000.
    - Dharavi in Mumbai (India): 1,000,000.
    - Neza (Mexico): 1,200,000.
    - Orangi Town in Karachi (Pakistan): 2,400,000.
    - More than 900 million people live in slums and shanty areas which are geographically separate from the most affluent and lack most of the basic services and facilities and state protection

iii) **Geographical marginalization:** Some communities or groups can be marginalized from the rest of the economy because their economic value is deemed minimal.

- The Governments make minimum investment on their education since the returns on this investment is very little. Such communities include children of nomadic communities such as the Tuareg of the Sahara and Sahel regions, the Massai of East Africa and communities from low productive areas such as the North Eastern Kenya, Lower Turkana, and parts of Southern Africa.
- In such areas schools are few and far apart and often ill equipped.
- The enrollment and completion rates are low and performance wanting.
- Children in these communities trek long, often unsafe distances sometimes without food or water to go to school.
- Many dropout due to these hardships, while others cannot maintain regular attendance hence participation is low.
- Indigenous groups also face barriers to full participation in society due to language, culture, and social organization differences from the dominant trends of the societies in which they live.
- They suffer from cultural discrimination, economic and political marginalization, are less likely to be registered at birth, more prone to poor health, to low participation in education, to abuse, violence and exploitation.
- Suffer scarce educational facilities, qualified teachers.
- Due to their lack of exposure and their kind of life, are disadvantaged from a largely irrelevant and unfamiliar curriculum
- Rural areas and slums tend to be poorer and more difficult to reach with education and other services than urban areas.
- In developing countries 30% of rural children are out of school compared with 18% of those in urban areas.
- Possible barriers to school attendance include distance to schools, the likelihood that their parents are less educated or do not value formal education, failure of government to attract good teachers in the countryside etc.

iv) **Political Marginalization:** this can take the form of poor representation in the government. Policy and the effects of politics on education.

- a. Poor representation is whereby a group is sidelined from full and democratic participation in decision making and hence, denied of their right to social, economic, and political benefit. In such a case, there is lack of political empowerment. The most vulnerable groups falling under this are women, ethnic minorities, migrants, and disabled persons, elderly.
- b. Policies such affirmative action which was mooted in 1997 and again in 2000
- c. o Affirmative action is an action or policy by the government, favoring those who tend to suffer from discrimination, especially in relation to employment or education; discrimination.
  - Its aim is to uplift the standards of historically discriminated or marginalized groups such as women and minority tribes
  - its benefits are to raise the discriminated groups
    - bring diversity of ideas and manpower,

- break stereotypes – women are good at this while boys do this better
- it can however lead to further discrimination and stereotyping by:
  - demeaning to the minority groups to mean they are not good enough
  - bring about unfair competition where the minority group may be favored over a more qualified person
  - lead to concentrating on the historically disadvantaged group at the expense of the other – in Kenya led to improvement and expansion of girls schools at the expense of boys schools especially in providing boarding facilities
- d. displacement due to political instability and conflict – Somali IDPs in Kenyan camps, IDPs in Kenya during the post-election violence, migrants from Turkey to Greece etc. – enrollment, participation and retention
- e. ethnic, religious and political discrimination whereby the favored group is catered for in all aspects of development unlike the less favored group- limited resources and development, low participation Armed conflict and clashes cause children to miss out on many essential services.
- f. ethnic, religious and political strife and conflict – school attendance and participation e.g. Genocide in Rwanda and Kenya during elections
- g. Boko Haram kidnapped 234 girls taking physics exams in April 2014, Mali, DRC, and Somali in violent insurgents destroyed schools and left the education system bereft of teaching professionals and inadequate infrastructure (Katharine, 2016).
- h. displaced, refugees or children separated from their families face deprivations and are exposed to several other risks such as rights violation and abuse – deprived of education
- i. Among the African countries Somalia has been most affected by war with a total lack of a functioning national administration since 1991.
- j. The result – plainly apparent in education – the net primary attendance ratio is the lowest in the world, at just 13% for boy and 10% for girls
- v) **Globalization:** Globalization has increased the gap between haves and have-nots and thus boosted marginalization. While it is true that some middle income developing countries, as well as the most populous countries, India and China, are gaining out of globalization, others are losing
  - Developing countries continue to lag behind in all spheres including education and suffer the effects of dumping, infiltration of foreign ideologies and practices, migration etc.
  - In education, schools in developing nations suffer from brain drain with many qualified teachers opting to take lower but well-paying jobs abroad rather than work in the countries especially in marginalized areas.
  - Infiltration of ideologies and practices such as religious radicalization have affected school attendance
  - the influx of skilled personnel has left many citizens without jobs or the necessary training hence led to rise in drop out and crime
- iv) **Disasters-** Natural and Unnatural: Disasters are a global phenomenon and a serious challenge to development.

**Natural:** earthquake, volcanic eruption, hurricane, tornado, ice storm, flood, landslide, wildfire, insect infestation, and disease outbreaks.

**Manmade:** Can be associated with technological advances, i.e., explosives, unexploded ordinance, toxic spills, emissions of radioisotopes, and transportation accidents.

- these can keep children out of school if they are victims or affected

**What are the advantages of educating all these marginalized groups?**

- Enhances the development of the country
- Equalizes people
- Eradicates poverty
- Promotes economic growth of the country
- Promotes health
- Protects the environment
- Generally leads to a more democratic society.

**How can this inequality be addressed?**

1. Improve on and enforce public policy and changes in attitude. Although world governments have put a lot of effort to do this, especially by signing, ratifying and enforcing international conventions, many nations are still a long way from achieving this as only about 62 out of the world's 195 countries or about 32% have achieved gender parity in both primary and secondary education and Africa lags behind.
  - Gender equality in educational opportunities and outcomes is the most challenging to achieve and is inherently more difficult to measure. Clearly much remains to be done. Most Sub-Saharan Countries, Kenya included, have a long way to go before they achieve gender parity and equity in education (EI, 2009).
2. provide free quality and relevant education to all primary and secondary levels to provide all with functional skills and knowledge
3. for EFA goals to be realized there is need for commitment by all the stakeholders to the girl and boy child education by providing
  - enough and targeted funding by government and donors to their education,
  - strengthening the gender unit by allocating enough financial and material resources,
  - strengthening the capacity of the National Task Force on Gender and Education by allocating financial resources for activities,
  - incorporating gender programmes in pre-service and in-service teacher training,
  - intensified advocacy for the endangered child education
  - appointment of more women in key administrative positions at school and policy making level,
  - Strategies and plans to address the major disparities identified at primary and secondary school level be formulated (UNESCO, 2000).

**Conclusion:**

Hence Children from minority groups and are at risk of missing out on an environment that protects them from violence, abuse and exploitation, and are unable to access education, essential services and goods in a way that threatens their ability to participate fully in society in future.

- They are excluded by their family, the community, the government, civil society, the media, the private sector and other children.
- Such children are said to be excluded or deprived.
  - Exclusion from essential services and goods such as adequate food, health care and schooling clearly affects children's ability to participate in their communities' and societies
- Exclusion can also lead to violation of rights such as protection against child abuse, inability to attend or fully participate in school
- Education provides an opportunity for girls and boys to become more empowered and self-confident as they acquire the range of knowledge and skills attitudes and values critical for negotiating an equal place in society.
- Governments all over the world therefore need to redouble their efforts to reduce inequalities and counteract all marginalizing factors and provide education to all children alike

i.